

SysAdmin

MAGAZINE

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TechTrend: Unveiling the Best Windows Tools for Sysadmins

SysAdmin Magazine is a free source of knowledge for IT Pros who are eager to keep a tight grip on network security and do the job faster.



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A Comprehensive Guide to Active Directory Monitoring Tools



Craig Riddell
Field CISO NAM at Netwrix

Effective Active Directory (AD) monitoring is a cornerstone for security and compliance. It empowers administrators to spot suspicious activity, including improper changes to AD objects like user accounts and Group Policy objects (GPOs), in time to avoid data breaches or minimize their impact.

Moreover, monitoring Active Directory is crucial for user productivity and smooth operations. In particular, monitoring domain controller (DC) performance and replication activity helps administrators ensure that users can authenticate and be authorized to access the IT resources they need to do their jobs. Indeed, a single improper change to

DC configuration or the installation of unwanted software could put both business continuity and security at risk.

When it comes to Active Directory monitoring tools, you have several options: free tools from Microsoft, a paid solution from Microsoft and solutions from third-party vendors. This document provides a brief guide to the best AD monitoring tools in all these categories.

Free Solutions from Windows: Tools from Microsoft

Microsoft Windows Server includes multiple tools for Active Directory monitoring, including the following:

- **Windows Event Viewer** enables administrators to review logs of significant events, such as user logins, account lockouts, changes to AD objects and AD-related errors. Note that the volume of logs can make manual review overwhelming.
- **Windows Performance Monitor** helps admins track server CPU usage, memory utilization and other performance metrics.

- **Windows PowerShell** can be used to write scripts to automate various AD monitoring tasks.
- **DCDiag** is a command-line tool for checking domain controller health and performance, including services and replication status.
- **Windows Group Policy** can be used to create policies to audit activity.

Paid Tool from Microsoft: System Center Operations Manager (SCOM)

For more in-depth insight than the free tools provide, Microsoft offers System Center Operations Manager for an additional licensing fee. SCOM's real-time monitoring and robust diagnostic and reporting capabilities help IT administrators maintain the health and performance of AD servers and services .

However, SCOM is complex, so using it effectively requires considerable expertise. Additionally, it is resource-intensive, and its cost may exceed the budget of many small or medium-sized businesses.

Third-Party Tools

For more robust and convenient Active Directory monitoring, many organizations choose a third-party solution. Many of the tools described below offer a free trial so you can see if they meet your specific needs.

Paessler PRTG Network Monitor

Paessler PRTG Network Monitor is a robust solution that enables comprehensive monitoring of entire IT networks. It readily identifies inactive accounts, changes to AD groups, replication issues and other key concerns. Plus, it can issue alerts based on the triggers you define and even respond automatically to known threats using built-in scripts.

Other key features of this solution include:

- Extensive range of customizable monitoring sensors for precise tracking
- User-friendly dashboard for real-time visualizations and alerts
- Advanced reporting capabilities for in-depth analysis and trend spotting

Paessler PRTG Network Monitor is available in two different packages, an enterprise version and one geared toward small and medium-sized businesses. The company also provides a hosted version in the cloud. The freeware edition includes up to 100 monitoring sensors; perpetual licenses can be purchased based on the number of sensors you want.

SolarWinds Server & Application Monitor (SAM)

SolarWinds Server & Application Monitor (SAM) is designed to monitor and manage a variety of IT infrastructure components. It helps IT teams track logons and other events to understand user activity and spot security threats, all from an intuitive dashboard. It also includes multiple health check tools to help ensure optimal performance of Active Directory and Entra ID (formerly Azure AD).

Other key features of SAM include:

- Detailed AD site views for network structure management
- Comprehensive tracking of DCs, including operational state and FSMO roles
- Insight into replication between DCs

You can download a 30-day free trial to try it out in your own environment.

Anturis Active Directory Monitoring

The Anturis cloud-based application provides a real-time Active Directory monitoring feature. It helps ensure smooth operations by auditing the performance and health of domain controllers, and helps prevent security breaches by tracking login attempts, password changes and other security-related events. It also provides efficient reporting with detailed information, which makes it easier to maintain and prove compliance with best practices and regulatory requirements.

Other features include:

- Alerting on irregularities or other potential issues in the AD infrastructure.
- Tracking of changes like user creation or deletion and modifications to Group Policy
- A cloud interface that is easy to navigate

ManageEngine ADAudit Plus and ADManager Plus

ManageEngine ADAudit Plus offers real-time monitoring and tracking of user activity and changes in the AD environment. Its detailed audit reports help administrators identify security risks and ensure compliance with various regulatory standards. ManageEngine ADManager Plus alerts on critical changes to enable quick response to security threats.

Other key features offered by both of these tools include the following:

- Auditing and reporting on authentication events and account lockouts
- Checking for stale credentials in services, applications and scheduled tasks
- Monitoring of changes to critical GPOs, such as password policy and account lockout policy
- User-friendly interface

You can download a 30-day free trial of ManageEngine ADManager Plus or ADAudit Plus.

Netwrix Auditor for Active Directory

[Netwrix Auditor for Active Directory](#) provides comprehensive Active Directory monitoring that enhances security, compliance and productivity. You can easily track and report on user activity and changes to Group Policy and access permissions, helping to ensure prompt threat detection and response.

Other key features of Netwrix Auditor for Active Directory include:

- Advanced reporting on Active Directory changes, access attempts and configurations
- Real-time alerts on critical changes and other security threats
- In-depth analysis of user permissions to facilitate tight access control, as required for both security and compliance with a wide range of regulations
- User-friendly interface that makes Active Directory auditing easy and convenient
- Frequent updates and enhancements to address emerging AD security threats and requirements

Netwrix Auditor for Active Directory is an ideal choice for organizations seeking comprehensive Active Directory monitoring. You can download a free trial to see how well it meets your needs.

Quest Active Administrator

Quest Active Administrator provides an integrated platform for effective administration, security and compliance across your AD environment. It allows IT professionals to manage AD objects like users and groups with relative ease, and its powerful auditing capabilities offer detailed insight into AD changes to enhance security and operational efficiency.

Other key features of Quest Active Administrator include:

- Automation of tasks like user provisioning and group management, reducing administrative workload while minimizing the risk of errors
- Standardized security policies that help enforce least-privilege access to sensitive data
- Customizable control templates that help simplify security permissions and delegation
- Regular assessment reports
- Intuitive dashboards

You can download a free 30-day trial of Quest Active Administrator to test it out.

Because of the vital role that Active Directory plays in authentication and authorization, effective AD monitoring is vital for security, compliance and business continuity. Choosing the right solution involves careful assessment of a variety of factors.

The most obvious criteria are cost and functionality. While most native tools are free, they are cumbersome and offer only limited insight into the Active Directory environment. For more comprehensive monitoring, alerting, reporting and other capabilities, organizations must look to third-party solutions.

However, another key criterion is long-term value. IT environments, security best practices, legislative requirements and the threat landscape are all constantly evolving. Accordingly, it's vital to choose an Active Directory monitoring solution that is regularly enhanced to keep up with the latest developments and emerging trends, so that it will help you maintain a secure, compliant and productive AD environment both now and into the future.

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See Netwrix
Auditor in Action

Launch In-browser Demo

Top Active Directory Management Tools



Ian Andersen
Vice President Pre Sales Engineering

While many organizations have transitioned elements of their infrastructure to the cloud, Active Directory (AD) remains the primary identity store, overseeing users, computers and permissions. Therefore, having the right tools for managing AD can make a substantial difference in efficiency, security and compliance, especially for IT teams that are a mix of experienced pros and those newer to network management.

But for smaller businesses with limited budgets and resources, getting the right tools can be a challenge. That’s why we’ve put together this list of the best Active Directory

management tools that offer a free version — or at least a free trial to kick the tires.

We’ll demystify the AD tool landscape by offering insights into a variety of tools. Our picks focus on Active Directory tools that will help you complete routine management tasks much faster so your team has time to focus on other priorities. From the robust offerings built into Windows Server to more sophisticated third-party solutions that offer advanced features, we’ll explore how these tools can help you maintain order, enforce security protocols and keep your network running smoothly.

Microsoft Tools for Managing Active Directory

Microsoft offers a suite of AD tools tailored for specific management tasks. These tools are accessible directly within the Windows Server operating system and can also be utilized on Windows 10 or Windows 11 by installing Remote System Administrator Tools (RSAT).

The most common Microsoft AD tools include the following:

- **Active Directory Users and Computers (ADUC)** — This

Microsoft Management Console (MMC) snap-in is the most used tool for day-to-day management tasks like user provisioning and creating and managing groups, computers and organizational units (OUs).

- **Group Policy Management Console** — This management console is used to create and manage Group Policy objects (GPOs), which enable IT teams to centrally configure and control user and computer environments across the network. For example, GPOs can be used to enforce security settings, deploy software and configure system settings.
- **Active Directory Sites and Services** — This tool is used to manage replication of data between domain controllers (DCs) and configure the network topology of Active Directory.
- **System Center Configuration Manager (SCCM)** — SCCM provides more comprehensive management in larger environments, from deploying applications, software updates and operating systems to managing inventory and compliance.

While these tools are sufficient for basic AD management tasks, they lack more advanced capabilities. A more robust option from Microsoft is Windows PowerShell.

Windows PowerShell can be used to automate a wide range of AD tasks, such as creating, managing and removing users, groups and computers. You can also perform some advanced functions like managing passwords, querying AD objects and modifying various AD attributes.

While PowerShell is quite versatile, using it effectively requires significant scripting expertise. To get started, IT pros can download this free Windows PowerShell Scripting Tutorial for Beginners.

For more robust features, such as automation, bulk operations, advanced reporting and security enhancements, without the need to master complex PowerShell scripting, IT teams need to look to third-party solutions.

Below are some of the third-party AD management tools available today. We have separated them into two groups: free and paid. Note that many of these tools perform singular functions that the others don't offer, so direct comparisons are not always possible. The optimal approach would be to try out several of these tools to determine which ones streamline your workflow effectively.

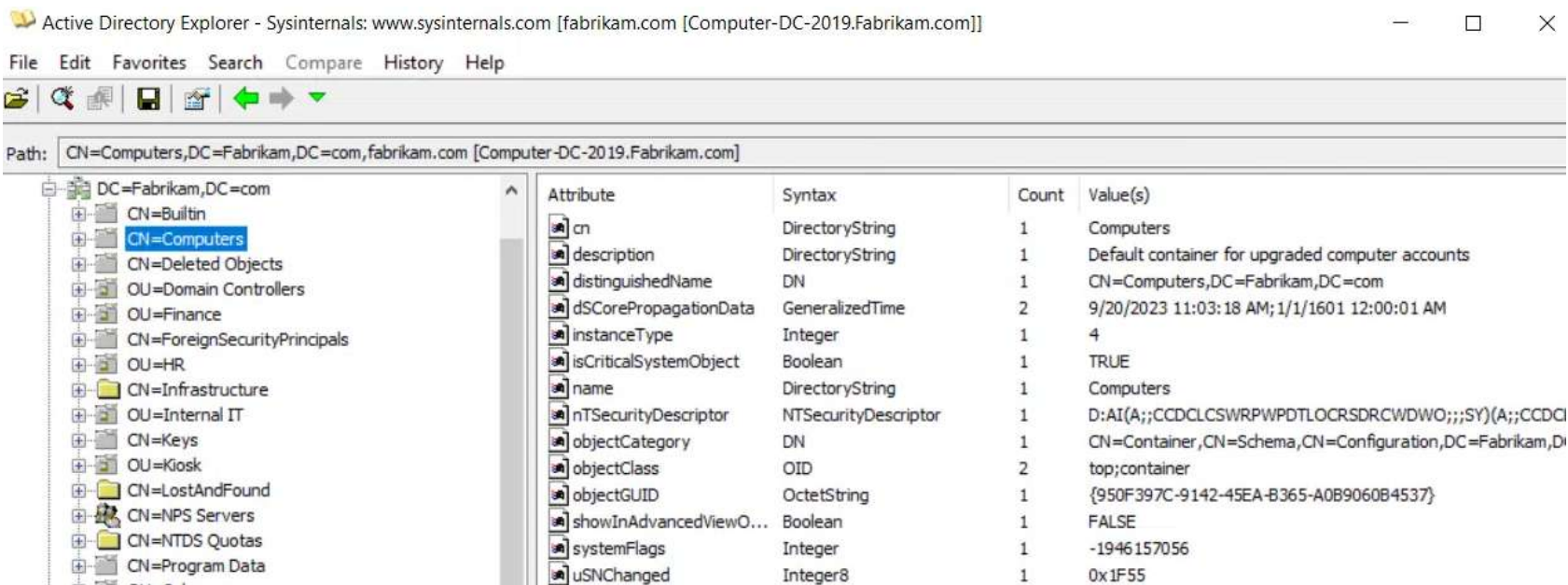
Free Third-Party Active Directory Management Tools

Below are some free Active Directory tools that many organizations find useful.

Active Directory Explorer

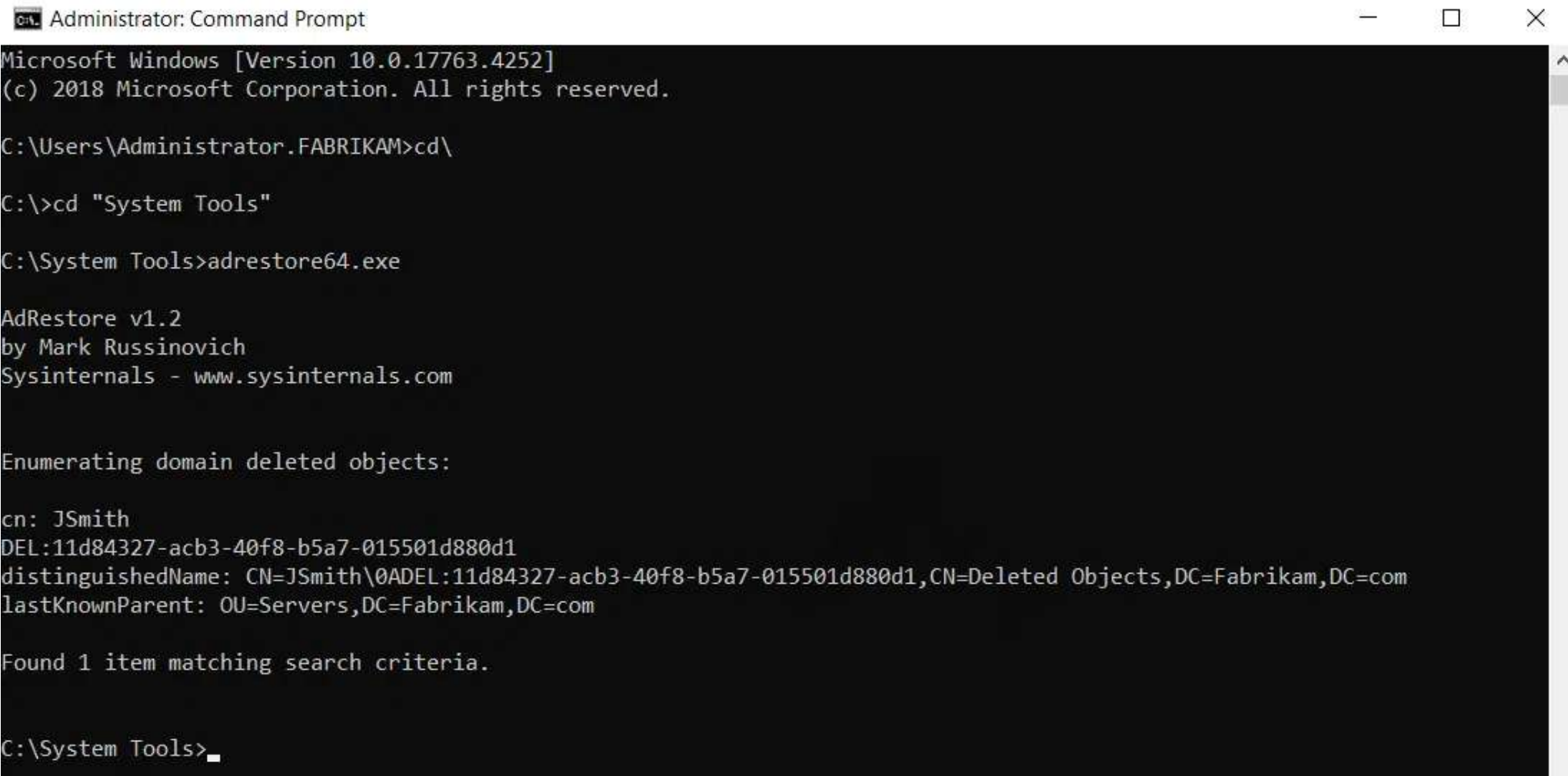
Active Directory Explorer (AD Explorer) is a free tool designed for both viewing and editing within the AD environment. It offers a user-friendly interface to seamlessly navigate AD databases, set up favorite locations, and inspect object properties and attributes. Users can easily modify permissions, analyze an object's schema, and perform complex searches with the convenience of saving and reusing these search parameters.

One of the key features of AD Explorer is its ability to create and store snapshots of the AD database for offline exploration and analysis — users can load and interact with these snapshots as if they were connected to the live database. Additionally, AD Explorer offers a unique comparison tool that highlights differences in objects, attributes and security permissions between two database snapshots, providing a clear view of changes over time.



Microsoft AdRestore

[Windows Server](#) 2003 introduced the ability to restore deleted (“tombstoned”) objects. Microsoft AdRestore is a single-task CLI tool that enumerates all tombstoned objects in your AD domain and enables you to restore them individually as needed.

A screenshot of a Windows Command Prompt window titled "Administrator: Command Prompt". The window shows the following text: "Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.17763.4252] (c) 2018 Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved. C:\Users\Administrator.FABRIKAM>cd\ C:\>cd "System Tools" C:\System Tools>adrestore64.exe AdRestore v1.2 by Mark Russinovich Sysinternals - www.sysinternals.com Enumerating domain deleted objects: cn: JSmith DEL:11d84327-acb3-40f8-b5a7-015501d880d1 distinguishedName: CN=JSmith\0ADEL:11d84327-acb3-40f8-b5a7-015501d880d1,CN=Deleted Objects,DC=Fabrikam,DC=com lastKnownParent: OU=Servers,DC=Fabrikam,DC=com Found 1 item matching search criteria. C:\System Tools>".

```
Administrator: Command Prompt
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.17763.4252]
(c) 2018 Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Users\Administrator.FABRIKAM>cd\

C:\>cd "System Tools"

C:\System Tools>adrestore64.exe

AdRestore v1.2
by Mark Russinovich
Sysinternals - www.sysinternals.com

Enumerating domain deleted objects:

cn: JSmith
DEL:11d84327-acb3-40f8-b5a7-015501d880d1
distinguishedName: CN=JSmith\0ADEL:11d84327-acb3-40f8-b5a7-015501d880d1,CN=Deleted Objects,DC=Fabrikam,DC=com
lastKnownParent: OU=Servers,DC=Fabrikam,DC=com

Found 1 item matching search criteria.

C:\System Tools>
```

Netwrix Auditor for Active Directory (Community Edition)

[Netwrix Auditor for Active Directory Community Edition](#) provides easy and comprehensive monitoring of activity in Active Directory. It tracks all user logons and changes to AD users, groups, OUs, GPO links and policies, and provides the crucial “what,” “when” and “where” details for each event.

This versatile free [Active Directory reporting](#) tool simplifies the process of auditing by automatically aggregating data from various sources and delivering daily email reports that summarize activity over the last 24 hours, including the before and after values for all modifications. This automated approach increases operational efficiency by eliminating the need to sift through extensive native logs and other time-consuming tasks.

For even more comprehensive [AD monitoring](#), there is also a paid version of Netwrix Auditor for Active Directory.

Netwrix Auditor for Active Directory

Activity Summary

Removed

1

Modified

2

Action	Object type	What	Item	Where	When	Workstation
Modified	Group	\\com\Enterprise\Builtin\Remote Desktop Users	enterprise.com	dc3.enterprise.com	4/14/2017 4:59:19 AM	atl-mkt021.enterprise.com
Security Local Group Member Added: "\\com\Enterprise\Users\Bill Hops"						
Modified	User	\\com\Enterprise\Users\Guest	enterprise.com	dc3.enterprise.com	4/14/2017 4:59:30 AM	atl-mkt021.enterprise.com
User Account Enabled						
Removed	User	\\com\Enterprise\Users\Diana Abraham	enterprise.com	dc3.enterprise.com	4/14/2017 4:59:40 AM	atl-mkt021.enterprise.com

Netwrix Account Lockout Examiner

[Netwrix Account Lockout Examiner](#) reduces the time spent on troubleshooting AD account lockouts by providing IT teams with a straightforward way to quickly find and address even complex issues. With one click, you can get to the root of the problem, whether it’s improperly mapped network drives, services or scheduled tasks running under stale credentials, or an outdated password saved on a mobile device. This functionality is especially valuable for locked service accounts.

Netwrix Account Lockout Examiner offers an easy-to-use interface: IT administrators can identify the reason for an account lockout problem simply by entering the relevant username, which enables them to focus on other important tasks.

The 'ENTERPRISE\T.Simpson' user account is locked. Some of the following applications and services may be using this account with an invalid password:

on Android 9 (IP: 192.168.1.0)

Exchange ActiveSync: Invalid password

on dc1 (IP: 172.28.51.21)

Human Factor: 1 access attempt with invalid password. Last attempt at 05/16/2020 5:34 AM (UTC)

2 errors found

Failed to read Credentials in 'exchange.enterprise.com'. Cannot find session ID for 'ENTERPRISE\T.Simpson' user.

Failed to read Credentials in 'dc1.enterprise.com'. Cannot find session ID for 'ENTERPRISE\T.Simpson' user.

View details

Start over

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Netwrix Effective Permissions Reporting Tool

[Netwrix Effective Permissions Reporting Tool](#) streamlines the process of tracking and reporting on user permissions across both Active Directory and file servers, thereby making it easier for IT teams to manage access rights

effectively and ensure that users have only the essential permissions for their roles.

The tool provides comprehensive reports that detail the specifics of user access and how that access is granted, whether through direct assignment or inheritance. IT teams can easily view both Active Directory group memberships and file share permissions in a unified report. By identifying and revoking unnecessary access rights, IT teams can tighten security and minimize the risk of a breach. This tool also simplifies compliance efforts by demonstrating that permissions are consistent with job descriptions and organizational roles.

Netwrix Effective Permissions Report for ENTERPRISE\T.Simpson

ENTERPRISE\T.Simpson is a member of the following groups: BUILTIN\Users

Effective permissions for ENTERPRISE\T.Simpson (object with inherited permissions are hidden):

Network Resource: \\PDC\Users\Administrator\Documents\Shared documents (File Path)

Object Path	Permissions	Has Access via Groups
Users [Share-level Permissions]	Full Control	Everyone
\\Documents\Shared documents\	Full Control	Everyone
\\Documents\Shared documents\Customer Care\	Read & Execute, Read	Everyone
\\Documents\Shared documents\Misc\	Read & Execute, Read	Everyone
\\Documents\Shared documents\Operations\	Modify, List Folder Contents	Everyone
\\Documents\Shared documents\Personnel Folders\	Full Control	Direct
\\Documents\Shared documents\Workflow\	List Folder Contents	Everyone

Netwrix Bulk Password Reset

[Netwrix Bulk Password Reset](#) enables users to reset local admin and user passwords across multiple workstations at once remotely, without logging into them. This functionality enhances Windows Server security by allowing for the swift reset of local admin passwords on multiple servers, thereby reducing the organization’s vulnerability to cyberattacks and reinforcing its overall security posture.

Netwrix Inactive User Tracker

[Netwrix Inactive User Tracker](#) is a freeware tool that specializes in identifying inactive user accounts. Its detailed reports on their age and period of inactivity offer actionable information to determine which accounts should be disabled or deleted to mitigate the risk of breaches and privilege escalation.

Netwrix Password Expiration Notifier

[Netwrix Password Expiration Notifier](#) streamlines AD password management by automatically emailing users and their managers to remind them to update their passwords before they expire. It also delivers regular summary reports on imminent password expirations directly to your inbox. As a result, this tool helps organizations remain in compliance with password security best practices while reducing helpdesk workload.

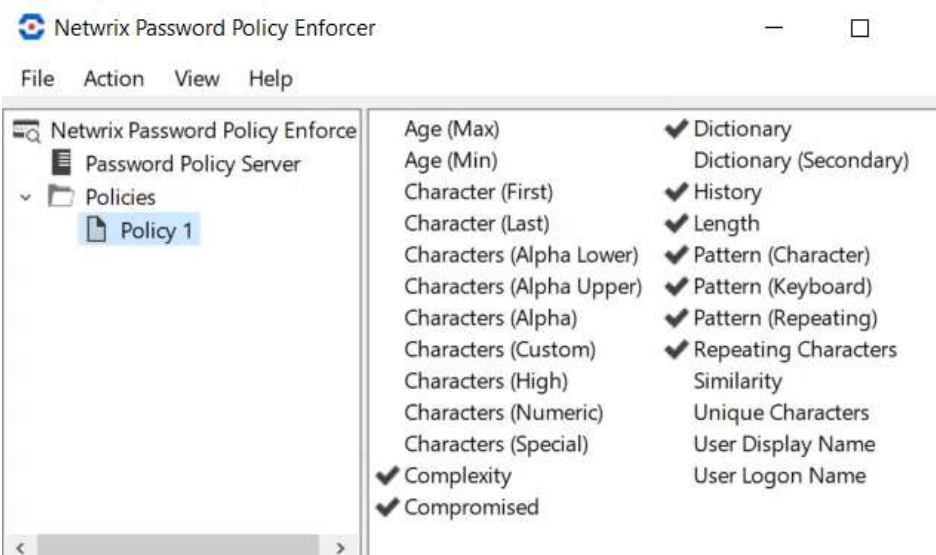
Passwords and/or accounts of the following users are about to expire:

User Name	E-Mail	Expires in
Administrator	Administrator@enterprise.local	0 day(s): password never expires
BBrown	BBrown@enterprise.com	0 day(s): password
LBlack	LBlack@enterprise.com	3 day(s): password
CMorisson	CMorisson@enterprise.com	4 day(s): password
BCliff	BCliff@enterprise.com	4 day(s): password
JBurns	JBurns@enterprise.local	5 day(s): password
JSmith	JSmith@enterprise.local	5 day(s): password
ABons	ABons@enterprise.local	5 day(s): password
LFrinz	LFrinz@enterprise.local	7 day(s): password
GGordian	GGordian@enterprise.local	8 day(s): password
FSamuelson	FSamuelson@enterprise.local	8 day(s): password
TDulton	TDulton@enterprise.local	9 days(s): password
FFranko	FFranko@enterprise.local	12 day(s): password
GGilby	GGilby@enterprise.local	13 day(s): password
FDeiton	FDeiton@enterprise.local	14 day(s): password
MZibakus	MZibakus@enterprise.local	14 day(s): password

Netwrix Password Policy Enforcer

[Netwrix Password Policy Enforcer](#) is a free tool that makes it easy to create sophisticated password policies that satisfy your unique security needs. It offers hundreds of customizable policies for users, groups and organizational units, along with over 20 adaptable rules to construct precise policies that thwart credential stuffing and brute-force attacks. Options for blocking weak passwords include analysis of character substitutions and checking against a vast database of leaked password hashes.

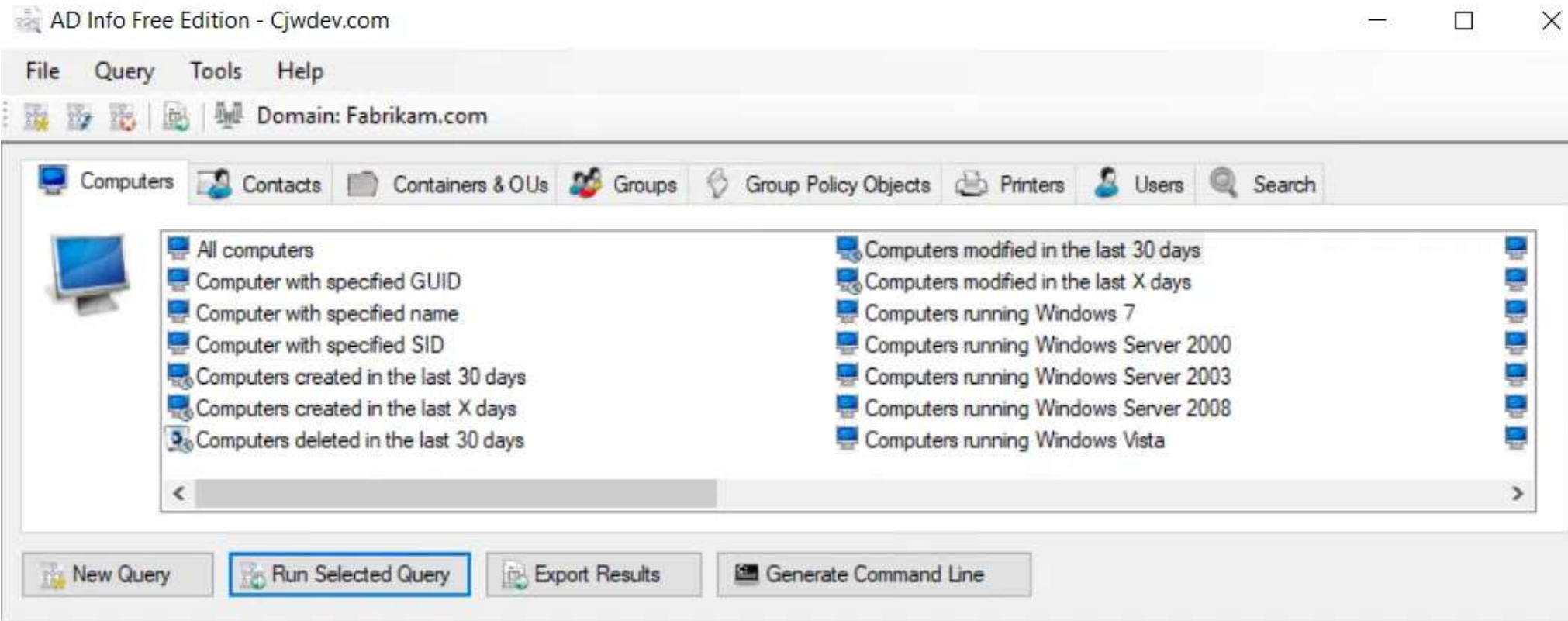
Netwrix Password Policy Enforcer supports regulatory compliance with ready-to-use templates for standards like CIS, HIPAA, NERC CIP, NIST and PCI DSS. It also includes integrated testing for policy effectiveness and compliance, ensuring adaptability to evolving password requirements and new regulations.



Cjwdev Active Directory Info, Free Edition

The free edition of Cjwdev Active Directory Info is an Active Directory reporting tool that allows you to run queries on the attributes you choose. Its queries handle direct and nested group membership, and help ensure accuracy by querying each domain controller for non-replicated attributes. The tool also supports multi-domain querying with simple domain name and credential inputs, ensuring versatility and broad applicability in diverse IT environments. Users can quickly generate CSV, HTML or TXT reports to gain insight into things like locked accounts, disabled users, users with the “password never expires” flag, and Group Policy objects modified in the last 30 days.

There is a standard edition that you can purchase that offers more features.



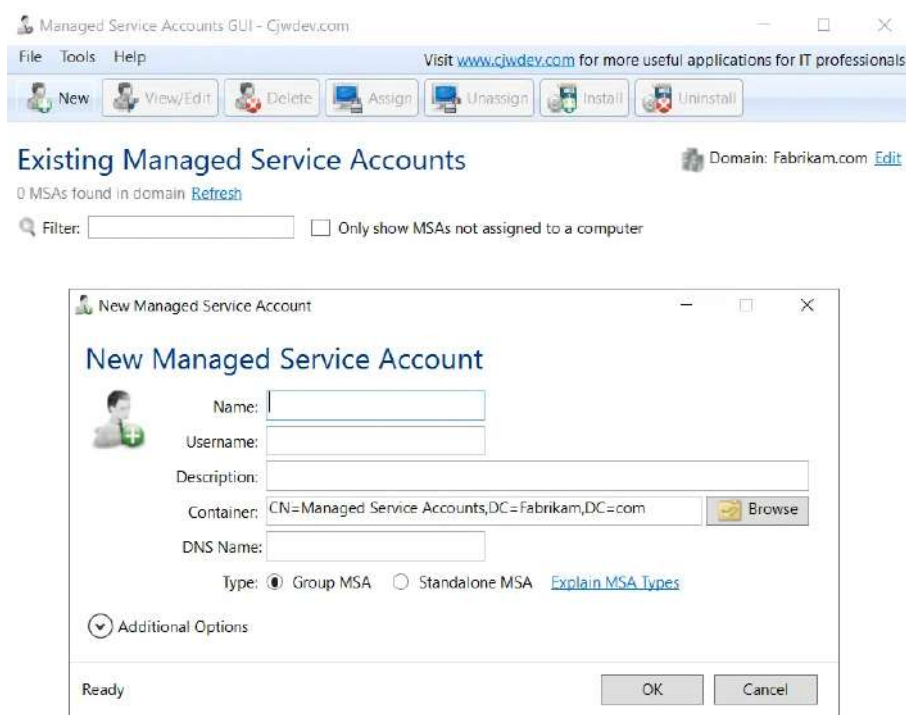
Cjwdev Group Manager

Cjwdev Group Manager allows the manager of a group to manage roles and settings for that group, including adding and removing members and exporting a list of group members to a CSV file.

The free edition enables you to manage only a single group, and you cannot or add new members from other domains. There is a standard edition that you can purchase that offers more features.

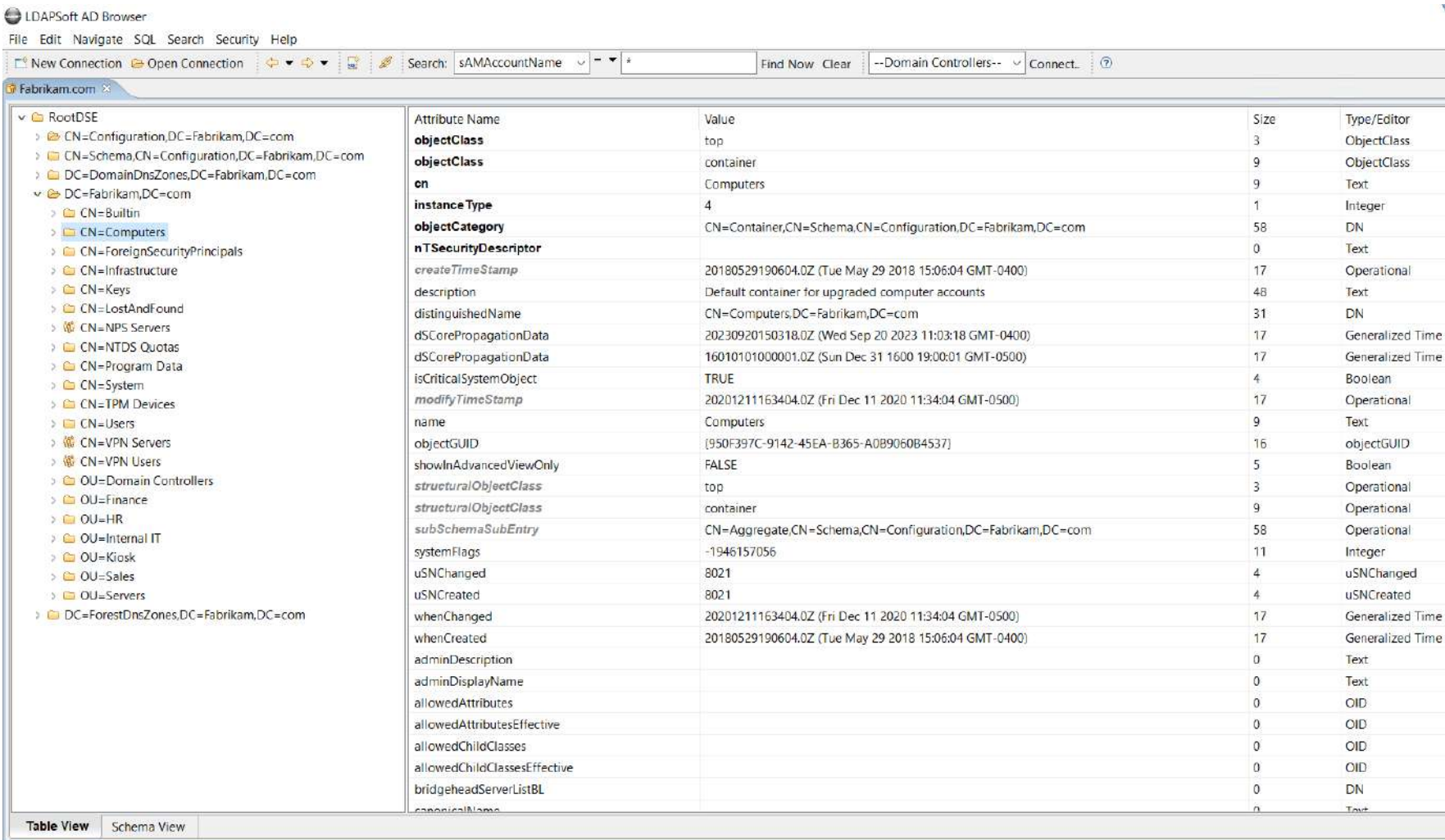
Cjwdev Managed Service Accounts GUI

Cjwdev Managed Service Accounts GUI helps you configure managed service accounts (MSAs) using an intuitive GUI that eliminates the need for PowerShell commands. The tool enables management across multiple domains with appropriate credentials.



LDAPSoft AD Browser

LDAPSoft AD Browser streamlines the process of browsing your AD hierarchy with read-only access by giving you a web-based view of AD. It offers robust text and visual search functionalities, including a convenient quick search bar for commonly sought information like employee emails and names. AD Browser allows you to view all available attributes and run SQL-LDAP statements. It supports a comprehensive range of directories and is compatible with both v2 and v3 of LDAP, facilitating seamless access to multiple directories through a single interface.



wiseDATaman Password Control

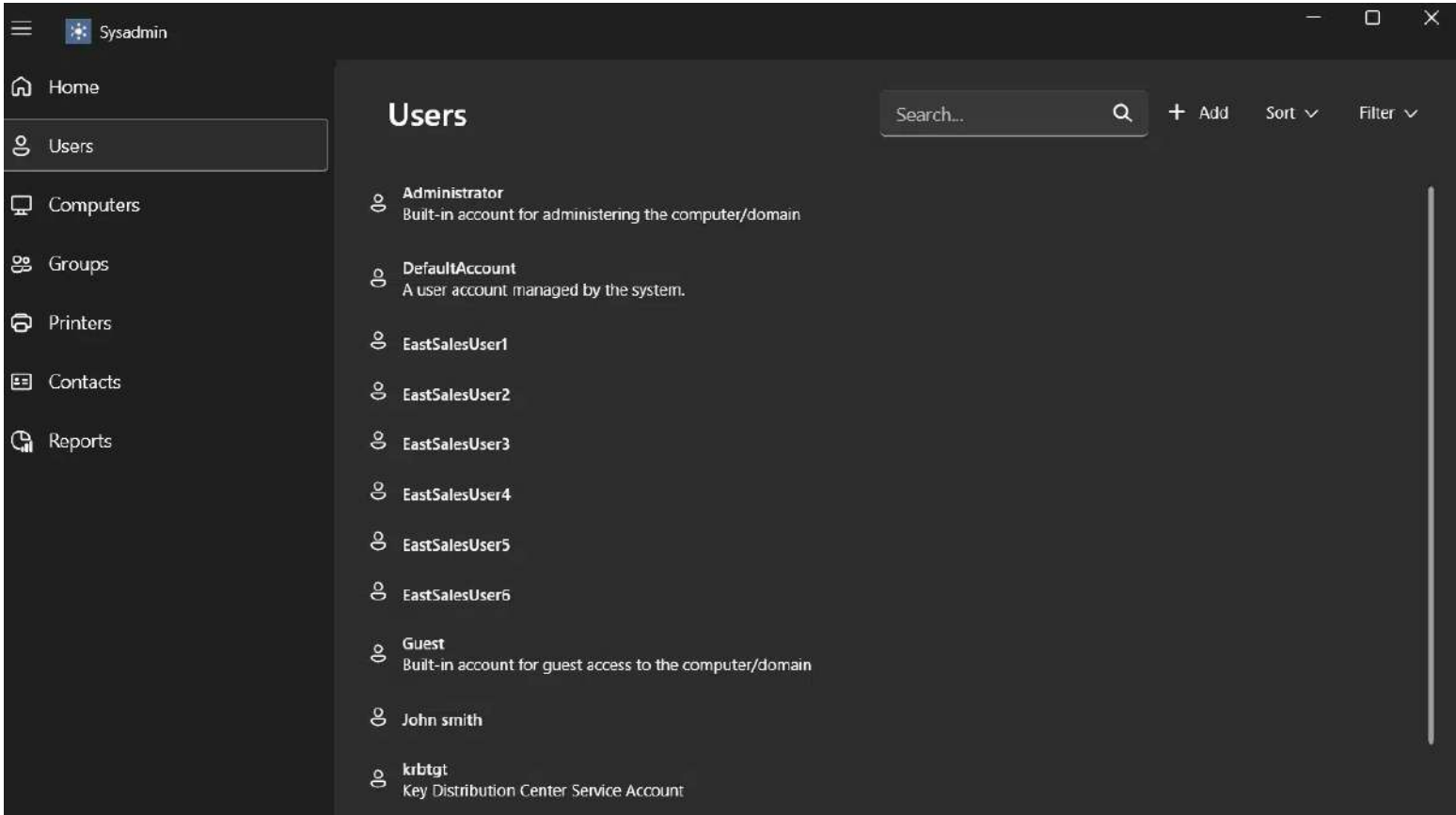
wiseDATaman Password Control streamlines the password reset process by offering IT support teams a user-friendly alternative to the MMC console. They can also reset passwords in bulk, which saves time and effort when managing service account passwords. Optimized for Active Directory domains, the tool also allows for enabling and disabling user accounts, with customization options available in the config file. It features a button for generating random passwords, which by default include a mix of uppercase, lowercase and numerical characters.

SysOps Tools AD Query

SysOps Tools AD Query enables users to quickly search AD for information about a specific user or computer, including schema attributes that are normally not readable. While the tool is free, the company does require quite a bit of personal information to access the download.

RIA-Media SysAdmin Anywhere

RIA-Media SysAdmin Anywhere a free multipurpose tool for administering Active Directory-based networks. It helps with resetting user passwords and querying objects, as well as managing AD objects by adding, editing and deleting photos. It also offers a variety of other functions that extend beyond Active Directory tasks.



Spiceworks People View

Spiceworks People View allows you to view and update AD user account properties, such as email, phone number, title and department. You can add devices to user profiles to monitor installed software programs and make updates when needed. You can also reset passwords and enable or disable user accounts. The tool also offers a self-service web portal for password and user profile management, and real-time status monitoring of all your devices.

Paid Active Directory Management Tools

Below are AD management tools that require a license but that do offer some sort of free trial.

MaxPowerSoft Active Directory Reports

MaxPowerSoft Active Directory Reports helps administrators manage and audit their Active Directory infrastructure. From an intuitive interface, users can generate detailed reports on user accounts, group memberships, organizational units, permissions and more. These reports can be used to improve security and demonstrate compliance with internal policies and external regulations. For example, users can identify anomalous changes, pinpoint inactive or expired accounts, check password status, and review login activity. Reports can be exported in various formats to meet different audit and compliance requirements, making this tool a versatile choice for any organization looking to optimize AD management. You can sign up for a free two-week trial.

ENow

ENow AD Monitoring & Reporting provides real-time monitoring of your AD environment from a single pane of glass. It helps you identify faults and failures across all critical AD components including domain controllers, DNS and domain replication. By identifying problem issues early

on, you can mitigate them before they evolve into bigger problems. The company does not offer a free version of this tool, but users can register for a 14-day free trial.

AlbusBit AD FastReporter

AlbusBit AD FastReporter makes it easy for IT personnel to generate, store, schedule and share AD reports. It includes a variety of predefined reports on your AD infrastructure and condenses report generation into a simple 3-step process. However, only the Pro version lets you input conditions and criteria to create custom reports. You can download a 7-day free trial.

Softerra LDAP Administrator

Softerra LDAP Administrator is a versatile tool for managing LDAP (Lightweight Directory Access Protocol) directories. Its intuitive interface allows administrators to navigate, search and modify directory entries with ease. The application supports multiple LDAP services and offers advanced features such as robust search capabilities, schema editing and access control management. Additionally, it simplifies complex tasks like directory synchronization, data

import/export, and security configuration. It is ideal for IT professionals of varying expertise levels. The vendor offers a 30-day free trial.

Softerra Adaxes

Softerra Adaxes is a robust solution for unified management of AD, Azure AD, Exchange and Microsoft 365. It simplifies delegation of administrative rights, enhances security with proactive monitoring and offers self-service capabilities to reduce helpdesk load. Its advanced reporting features aid in compliance and auditing, and its customizable interface adapts to the unique roles within IT teams. It is a good solution for organizations with multiple AD domains or hybrid environments. You can try it out for free for 30 days.

Zohno Z-Hire and Z-Term

Zohno Z-Hire and Z-Term are single-task tools. Z-Hire speeds up the user account creation process for new hires by automating the IT user account creation process for Exchange mailboxes and Active Directory and Lync accounts. Zohno claims Z-hire can reduce account deployment time by 600%.

Z-Term allows IT administrators to perform common tasks from a single interface when an employee leaves the company. Both tools offer free trials.

ManageEngine ADManager Plus

ManageEngine ADManager Plus streamlines various AD management tasks. It facilitates bulk management of user accounts and other AD objects, provides detailed reports, and automates routine tasks like user provisioning and de-provisioning. Its role-based access control simplifies delegation while ensuring security. The tool also offers a workflow to manage ticketing. You can use ADManager Plus for free for 30 days.

CENTREL Solutions XIA Automation

CENTREL Solutions XIA Automation automatically provisions user accounts in Active Directory, Exchange and Microsoft 365. You can also automate or delegate common management tasks, such as bulk account provisioning and password changes. You can do all these things using a web interface or mobile device, making this a highly versatile tool. You can download it for a 30 day trial.

With so many options to choose from, it can be challenging to find the right mix of AD management tools for your needs. The most effective strategy is to install different tools and try them out in your AD environment. This will give you insight into how well they work for your specific needs and preferences.

FREE GUIDE

Active Directory Security Best Practices

Download Now

Find the Best Registry Cleaner to Clean Your Windows Registry



Dirk Schrader

VP of Security Research at Netwrix

As you use your computer, the registry can collect obsolete, redundant or even damaged entries. By using a reg cleaner tool, you can:

- Remove registry entries left behind by uninstalled applications
- Reduce the size of the registry
- Identify and fix corrupted registry entries
-

However, there is no clear consensus on the value of registry cleaning. While reducing the number of registry entries for

the OS to parse through during startup might improve boot times, some experts say the performance enhancements are negligible: There are often literally hundreds of thousands of registry entries on a given machine, so removing even a few hundred orphaned entries is not likely to have a major impact on the system's performance. Moreover, some experts argue that the risk of mistakenly altering or erasing vital registry entries outweighs any advantages.

In any case, spending money on a registry cleaning tool doesn't rank as a priority for most people. That's why many computer users look for free registry cleaners to do the job. As complex as the registry is, most free registry cleaners have user-friendly interfaces that make them easy to use. Some also bundle in extra utilities to further bolster your system's efficiency.

To help, we looked at five of the leading free registry cleaning tools to determine the best free registry cleaner available today. All the tools were tested on a single computer that had never undergone any form of registry cleaning. We used each of these free registry cleaner Windows 10 tools to scan the registry and checked how their results differed.

Important: Before you use any registry cleaning tool, back up your registry. All the tools described here provide a means to do that, either manually or automatically.

Important Caveats

While all these programs are free, the adage "buyer beware" certainly applies. In particular, pay attention to the following caveats:

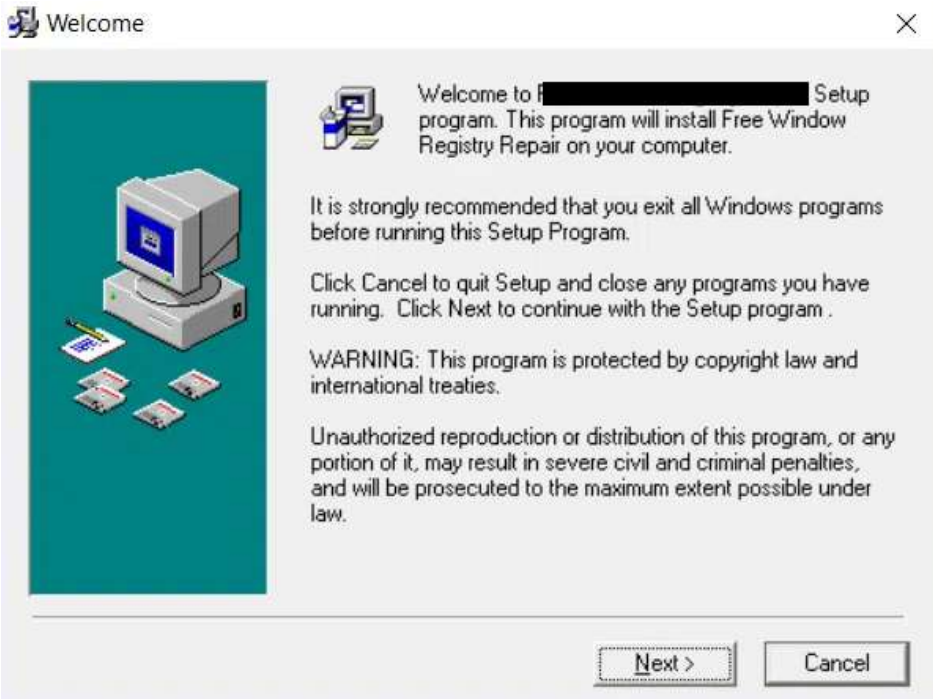
- If a tool gives you the option for a custom installation option, choose it. This can help you control preferences like desktop shortcuts and potential bloatware.
- Many free tool push users to purchase a 'Pro' or 'Premium' version with additional features.
- Some free tools are bundled with unrequested software or adware, so users need to be vigilant during installation to sidestep these extras.
- Free tools come with limited or no official support.
- Free tools are not perfect, so they are bound to categorize legitimate entries as errors from time to time, which could lead users to remove necessary registry entries. It bears repeating: Back up your registry before making any changes to it.
- Many free tools have not been updated in years, which means they may not be supported by newer operating systems and probably have unaddressed bugs.

Some of these factors led us to opt against completing the installation for two registry cleaning tools that we had planned to test. In one case, the malware protection on our test machine discouraged us from continuing to the download page, as shown here:

Website blocked due to riskware

Website Blocked: pcapp.store
v2.6.10 | Riskware: 2.0.202309081639
Malwarebytes Browser Guard blocked this page because it may contain malicious activity.

The other tool’s installer had a very outdated look, which suggested that it has not been supported for a long time and thus might pose high risk:

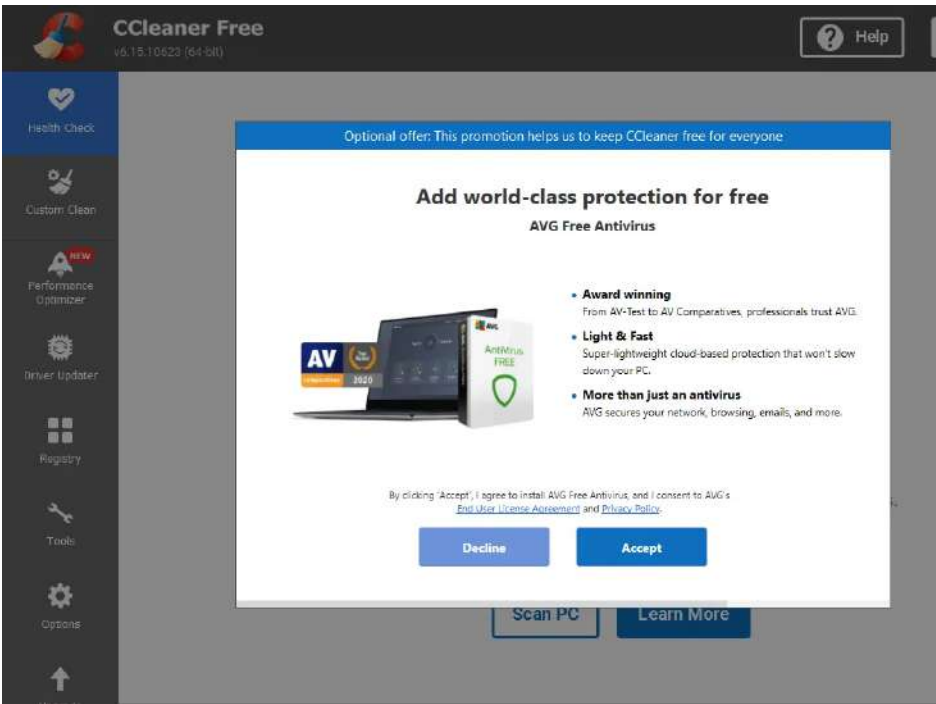


CCleaner

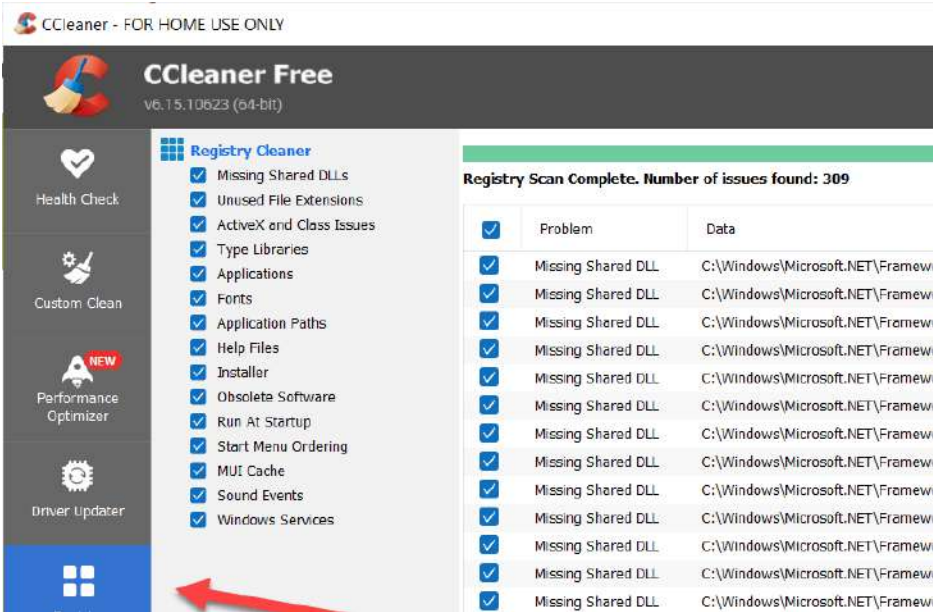
CCleaner is one of the most popular system optimization tools for Windows operating systems today. It comes with multiple features, including a registry cleaner. It offers a custom installation option, as shown below, which is recommended.



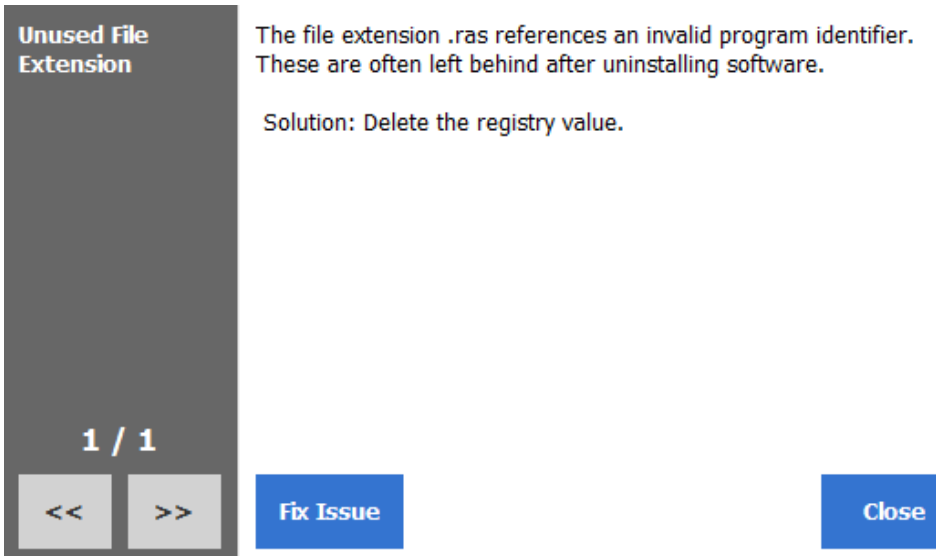
One of the first things that CCleaner does is push another free application, so be attentive during installation to ensure you don’t inadvertently install unwanted software.



The screenshot below illustrates the results of a registry cleaning scan.



You can then choose to remediate all the issues at once or to fix them individually, as shown below.



Pros

- Is known for its dependable and effective cleaning capabilities
- Offers a wide range of other PC optimization options, such as managing startup items, uninstalling software and cleaning up temporary files
- Is available in both installable and portable versions
- Clearly prompts the user to back up the registry before making any registry modifications

Cons

- Might come with extra bundled applications
- Often prompts users to upgrade to the premium version for enhanced features
- Does not provide detailed explanations regarding the different registry sections and entries, which can be daunting for some users
- Does not provide real explanations of the various registry categories and entries
- Was compromised in 2017 by hackers who added a backdoor to the software. The issue was addressed in quick fashion by the company; however, the incident raised issues about the software’s security.

Upshot

If you are looking for an all-in-one tool, CCleaner may be a better option than others.

CCleaner Paid Versions

CCleaner also offers two premium consumer versions:

- A one-year, single-device license that includes scheduled cleaning, priority support, a software updater and a driver updater

- A license that supports up to three devices for either one or two years, which comes packed with all the features of the single-device license plus file recovery and support for Android and Mac devices

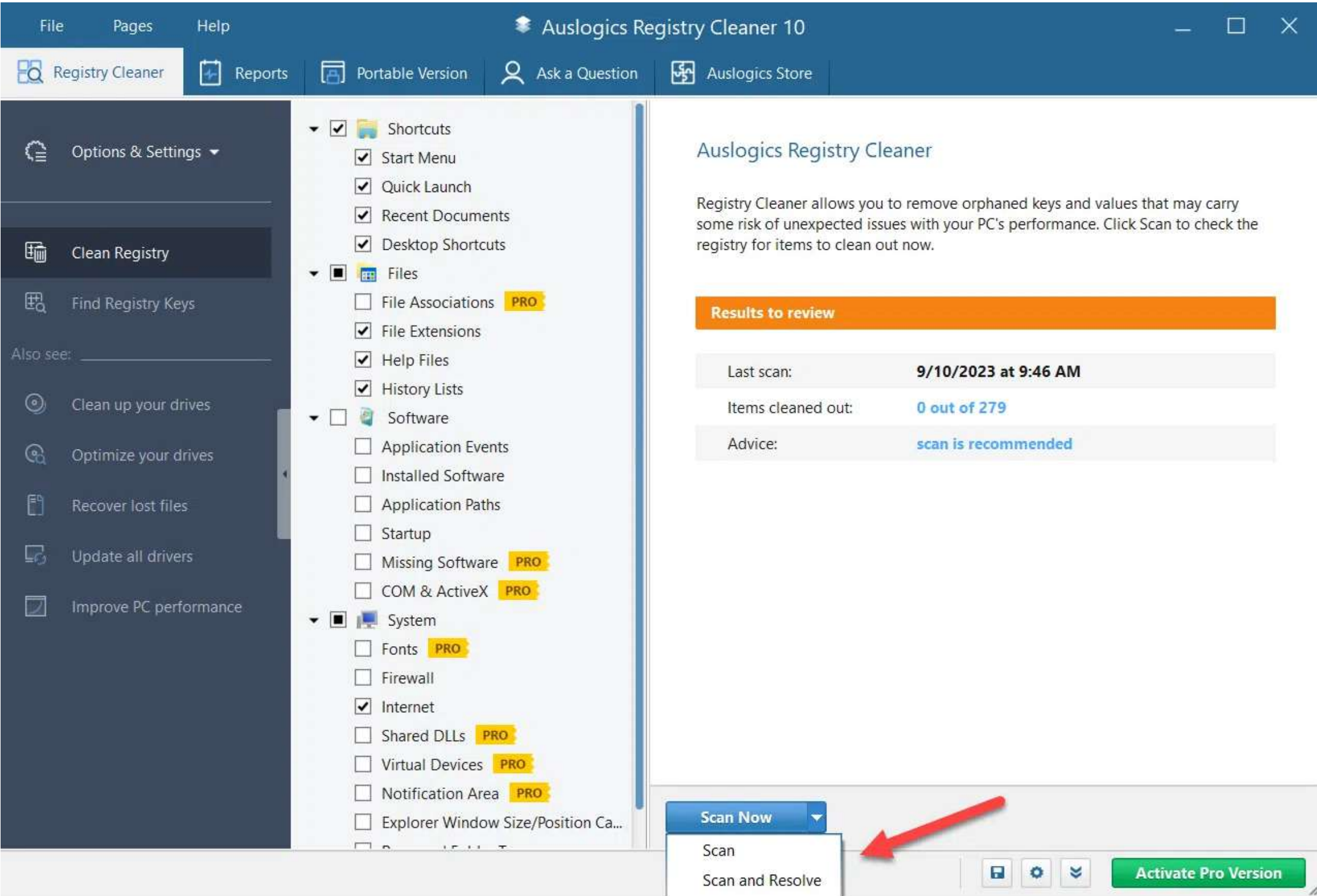
CCleaner also offers a paid cloud version geared towards businesses.

Auslogics Registry Cleaner

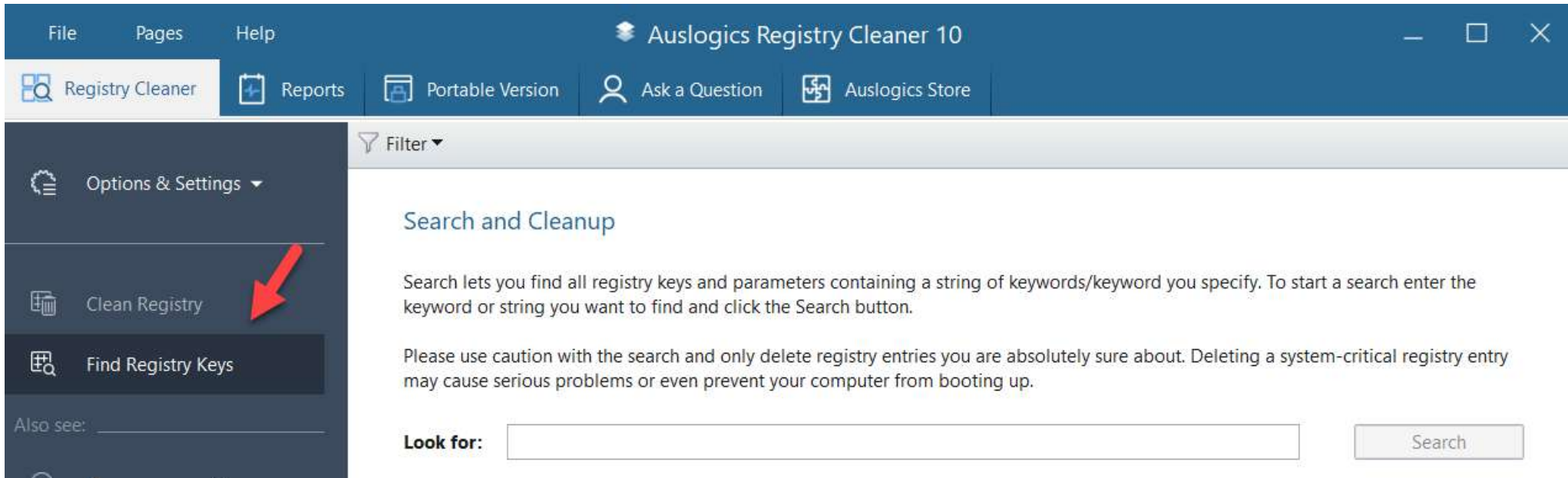
Like CCleaner, Auslogics registry cleaner has been around for many years and offers more PC optimization tools than just a registry cleaner, as shown here.



The interface of Auslogics is very clean. Some of its capabilities are available only with the Pro version; they are clearly labeled. Users can choose to “Scan” only or to “Scan and Resolve” in one step.



The interface of Auslogics is very clean. Some of its capabilities are available only with the Pro version; they are clearly labeled. Users can choose to “Scan” only or to “Scan and Resolve” in one step.



It also lets you create a portable version of the application that you can run it from a USB stick, which enables you to clean the registries of multiple computers without the need to install it on each device.



Pros

- Features a unique registry key search capability not commonly found in other cleaners
- Is available in both installable and portable variants
- Automatically backs up the registry before implementing changes

Cons

- The free version has limited functionality, which can be expanded only by upgrading to the paid Pro version.
- As with many cleaners, the installation process might attempt to include additional programs or bloatware. Users should remain attentive during installation to avoid these.

Upshot

With its main emphasis on cleaning the Windows registry, Auslogics will do the job, but other alternatives offer more options.

Auslogics Paid Version

Auslogics also offers a paid license for up to three PCs that includes priority support and enhanced cleanup features such as:

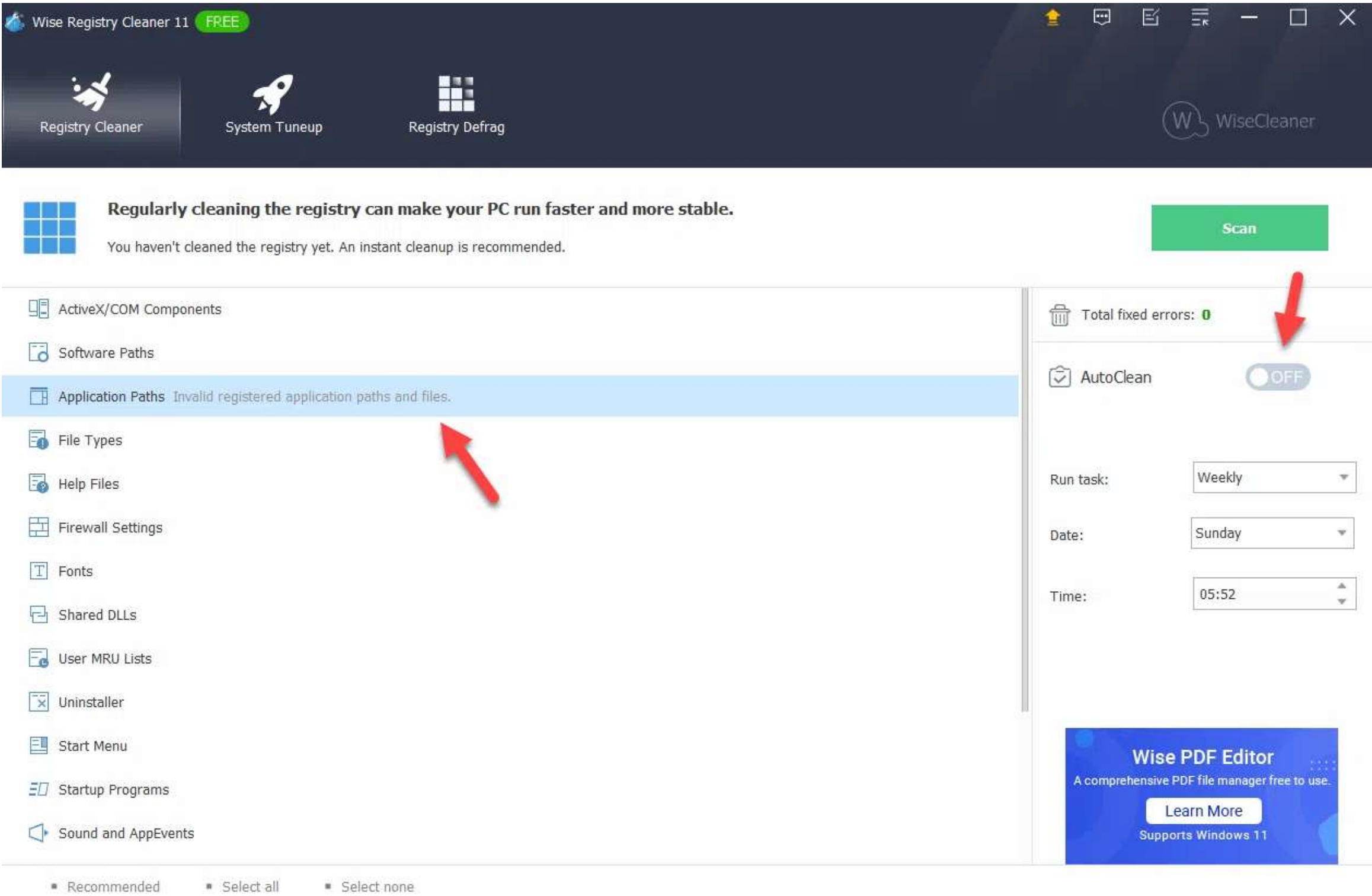
- Purging entries linked to file extensions that aren't tied to any applications or are related to absent apps
- Removing invalid paths to files or folders belonging to previously installed apps
- Cleaning up entries for services, device drivers, codecs and other items that have been removed or do not exist

Wise Registry Cleaner

The installation process for Wise Registry Cleaner is simple and concise. There is a custom installer option, but the only customizable feature is where to install the program. While the installer did not push and bloatware, the download page did forward me to a promotional page advertising other PC optimization products from the company.

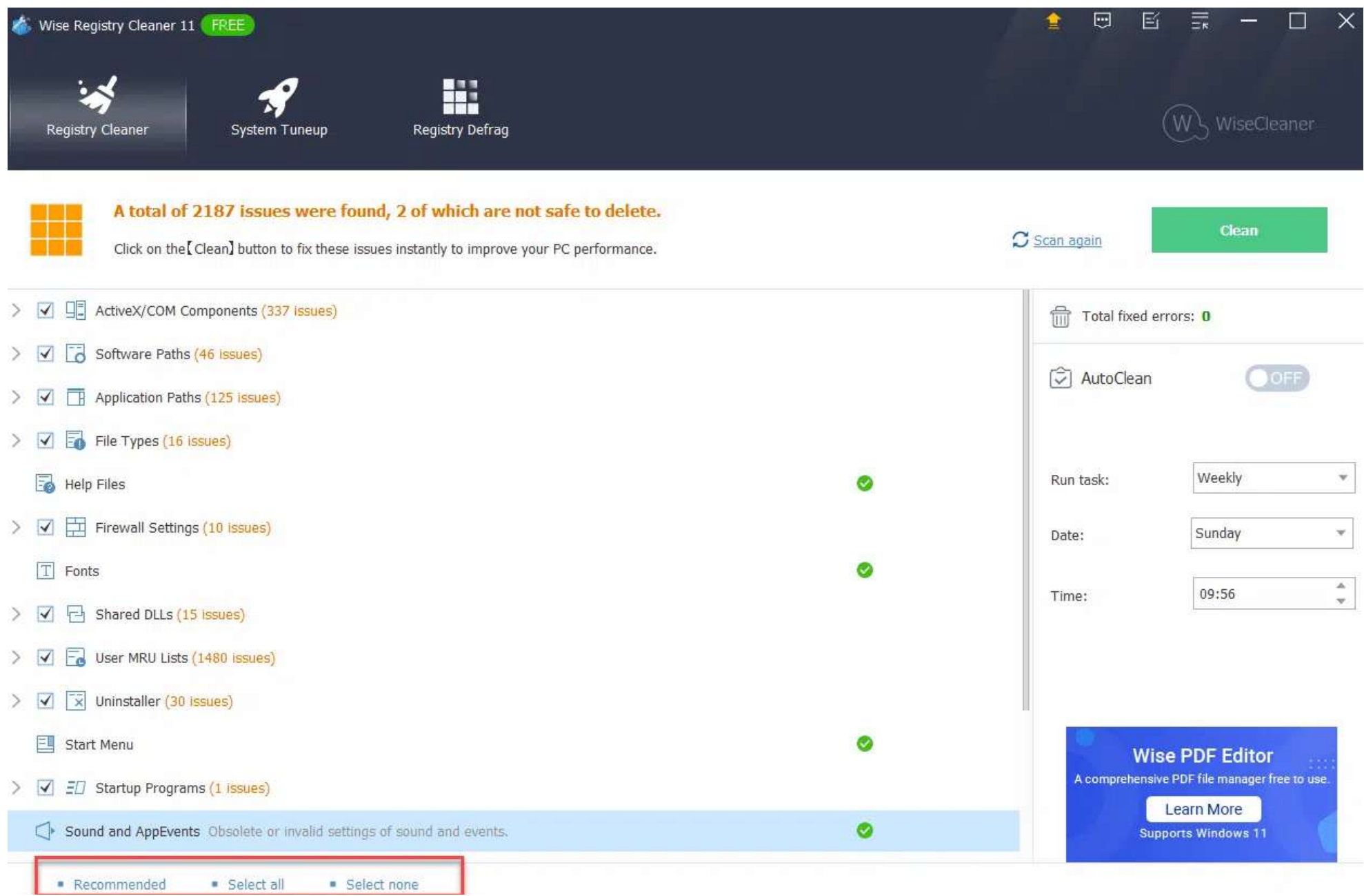


While the Wise Registry Cleaner does include a couple of other features, it pretty much focuses on the registry. Like the other tools, it splits the registry settings into various categories. Unlike some of the others, however, you can get a short description of any category clicking it, as shown below. In order to schedule regular cleanings, you must upgrade to the Pro version.

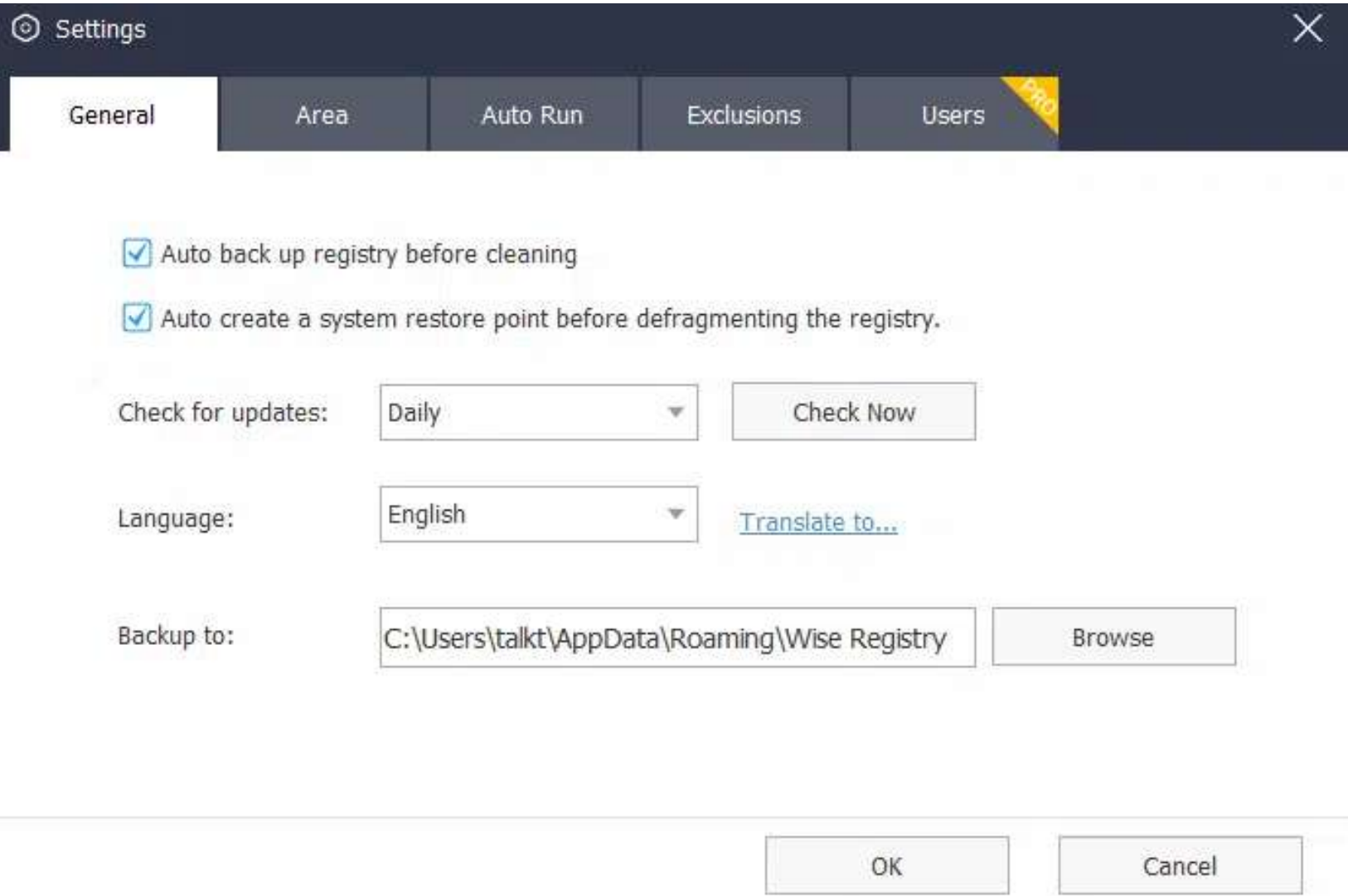


The Wise registry scanner identified more potential issues than some of the other tools. However, this doesn't necessarily mean they are genuine problems. It did provide a warning that two of the entries were not safe to delete.

As shown below, certain categories feature green checkmarks. While their exact meaning isn't specified, it's likely these checkmarks indicate the free categories. At the screen's base, there's an option to filter issues, but clicking on "Recommended" did not seem to make any difference in the list of issues displayed.



Wise offers more configuration settings than other tools, including whether to automatically back up the registry prior to cleaning, how often to check for updates and an authorized user list.



Pros

- Easy to install with no bloatware to worry about
- Can automatically back up the registry before cleaning
- Categorizes registry errors as “Safe” and “Not Safe to Delete”
- Provides the ability to create portable versions

Cons

- Some features appear to be free but require an upgrade to the paid Pro version, such as scheduling regular cleanings.
- The tool may report many issues that are not important.

Upshot

If you want a standalone registry cleaner that is simple to use and the free version can do the job for you, then Wise Registry Cleaner is a good option.

Wise Registry Cleaner Paid Version

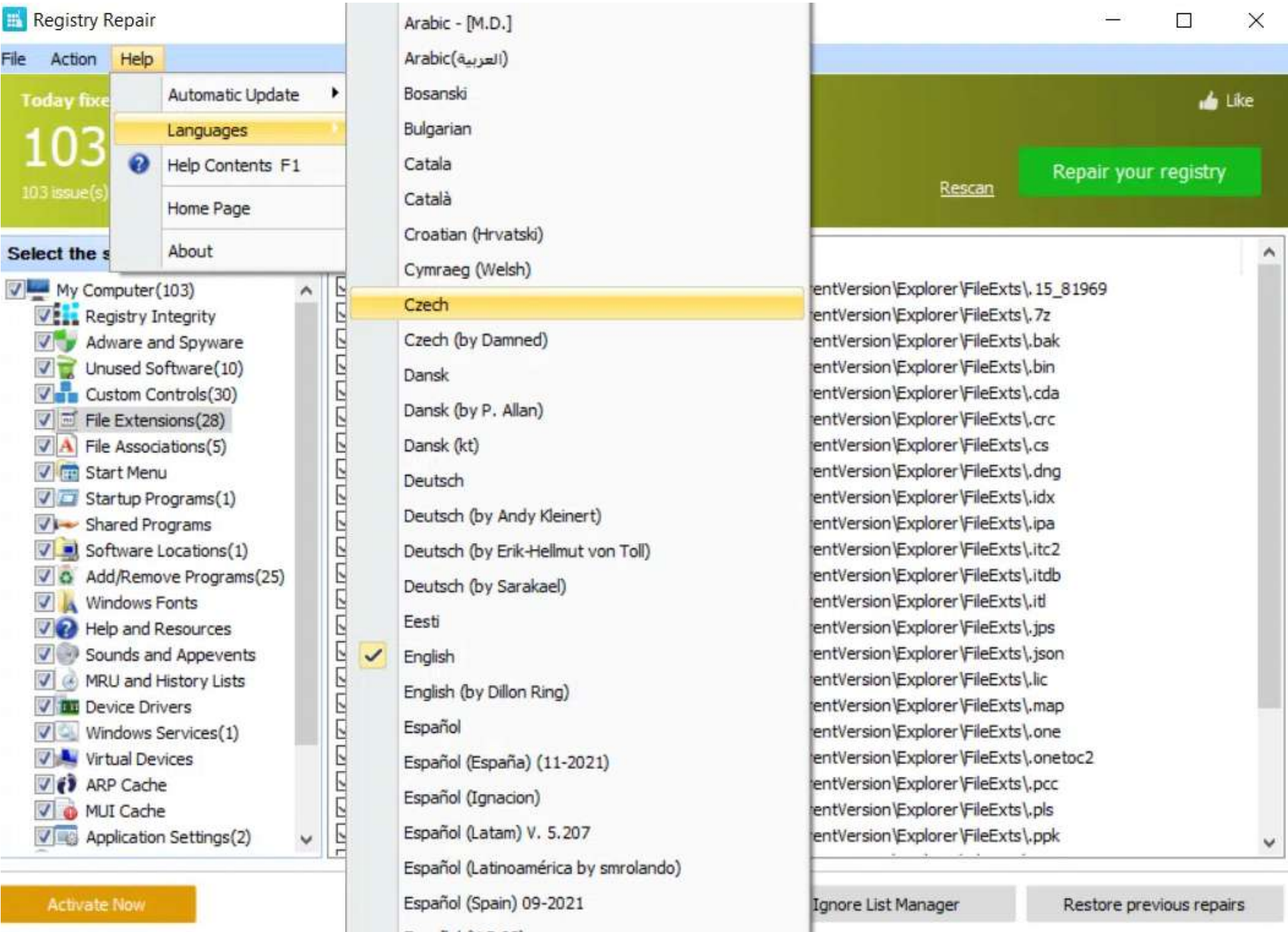
Wise Registry Cleaner Pro offers a one-year paid license that includes premium support as well as the ability to schedule registry cleanings daily, weekly or monthly. It also provides restore point capabilities and support for more registry entries, along with a desktop shortcut so you can clean the registry by simply clicking an icon instead of having to open the program..

Glarysoft Registry Repair

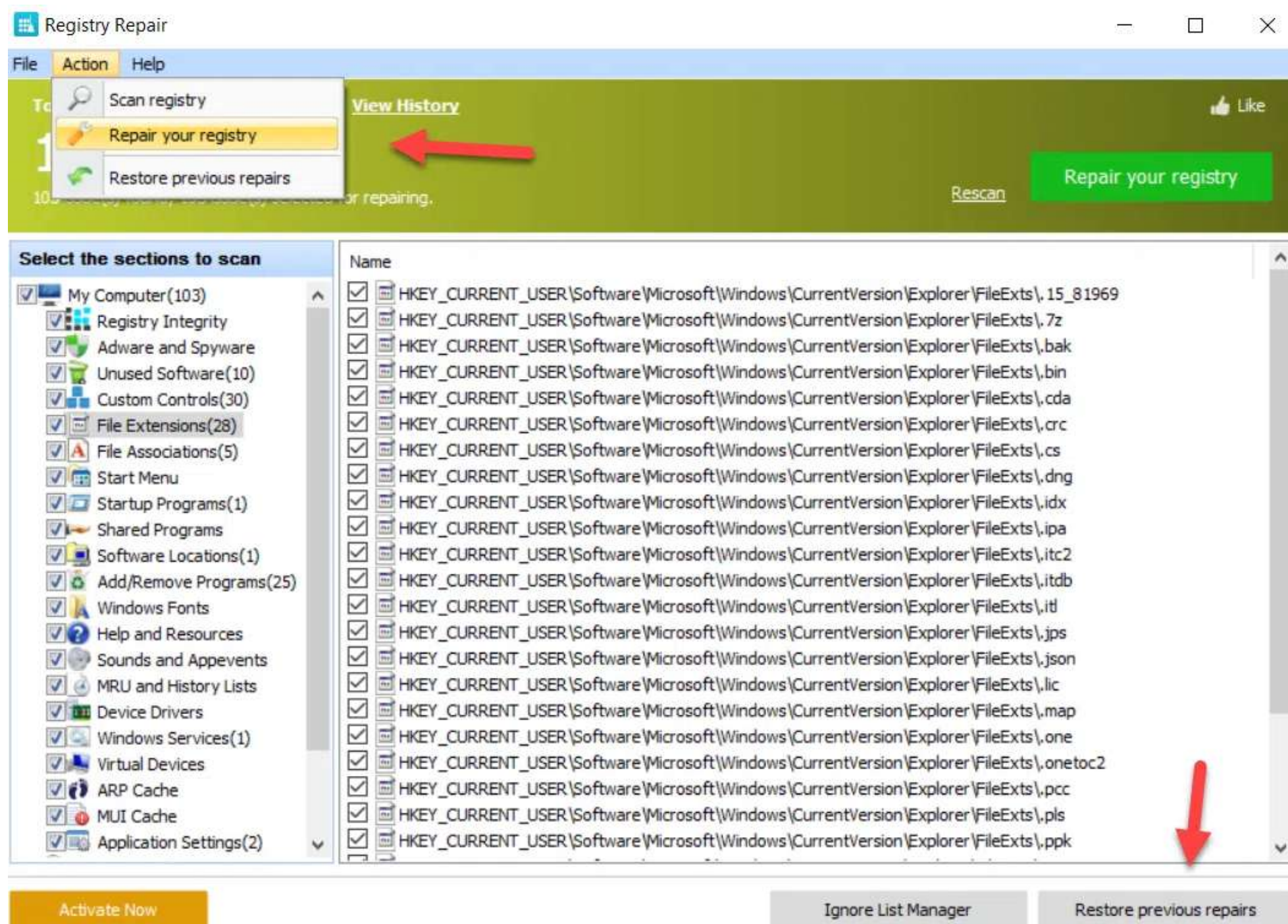
Glarysoft Registry Repair is another dedicated registry cleaner that doesn't offer a lot of bells and whistles but gets the basic job done. The installer offered no customized option, but it does give you the option to choose the install location and shortcut options.



Once the installation is complete, the program launches into the scanning process automatically, which users may or may not like. This tool is truly designed for an international audience, with many language options. It also includes settings to automatically manage updates.



The scan results are organized into categories that are relatively straightforward to understand, and as depicted below, you have the option to revert any previous repairs.



Pros

- Offers automatic updates
- Creates backup automatically before addressing issues
- Has an uncluttered interface that is easy to navigate
- Support many languages

Cons

- Hard to discern what additional features upgrading would provide
- Does not offer portable versions

Upshot

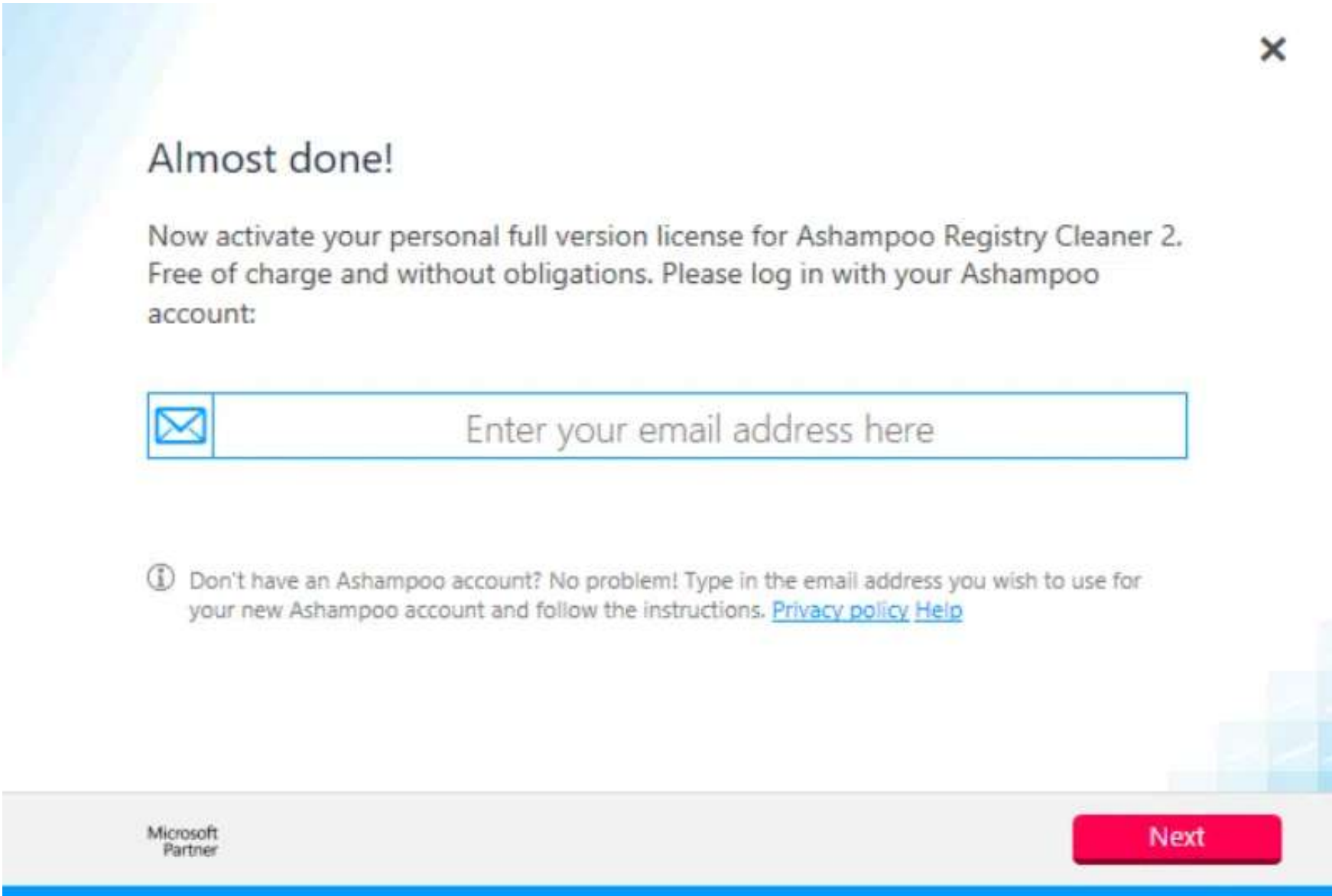
Glarysoft is a solid registry cleaner. However, to get the PC optimization features offered in the free version of CCleaner, you must upgrade to the paid version of Glarysoft.

Glarysoft Paid Version

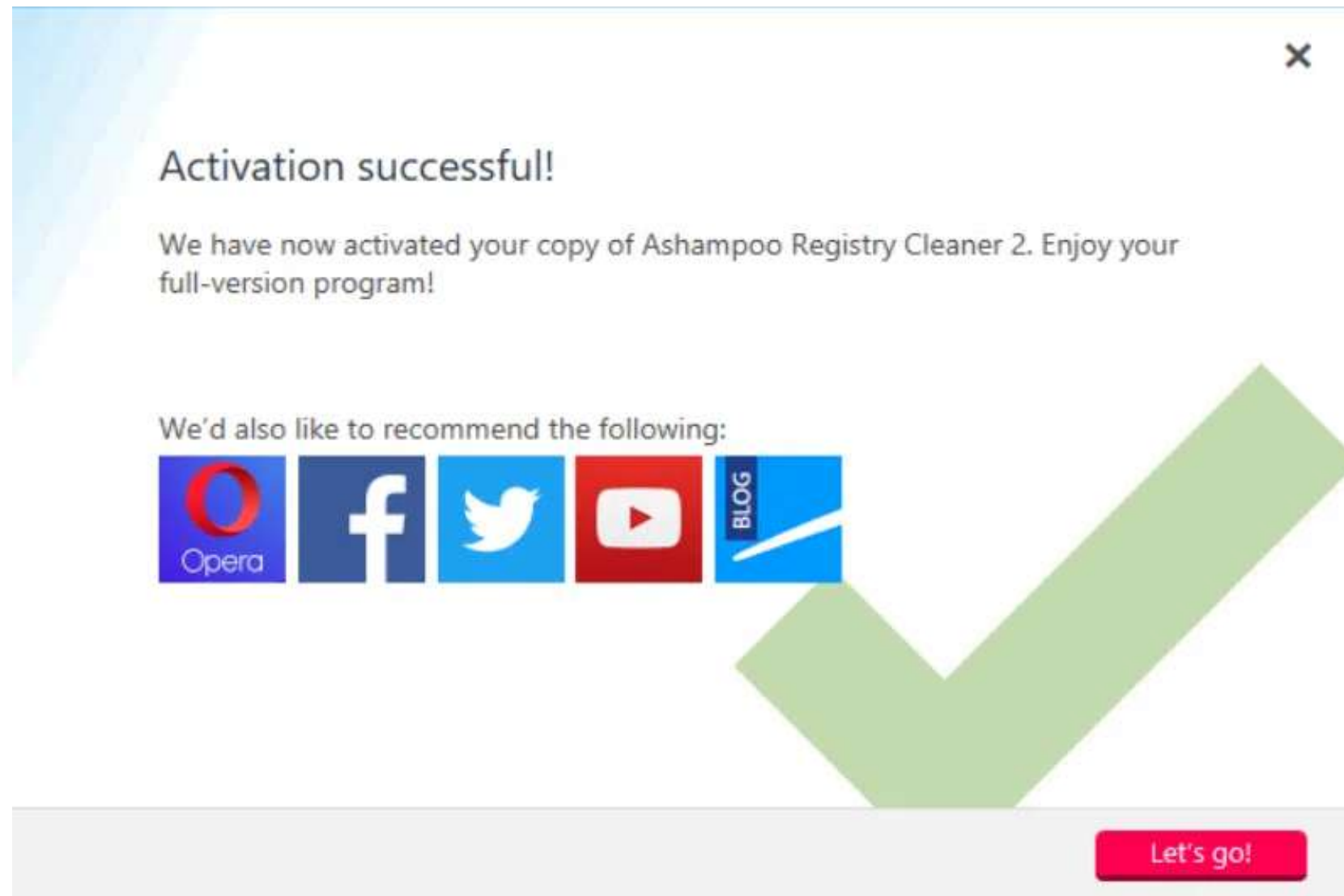
Glarysoft also offers an all-in-one PC optimization utility that performs additional maintenance services beyond registry repair. It includes the ability to clean up junk files, fix system errors, clear privacy records and optimize computer performance. You can purchase a portable version that supports up to 3 devices for one year.

Ashampoo Registry Cleaner

Ashampoo Registry Cleaner is an easy-to-use tool that does an efficient job of managing registry problems. The install process was straightforward without any bloatware prompts. However, the installation process did force me to create an online account in order to register and activate the tool.



After I clicked on the link in the email from the company, the tool was activated, as shown below.



The scanning and results process is much the same as all the other tools.

Ashampoo
Registry Cleaner 2

< Summary

Select all

Select none

Search for...

All

All unnecessary objects in the registry database

281 Objects

File formats

File formats were entered wrongly or faulty

47 Objects

COM, OLE, ActiveX

System objects were entered incorrectly or incompletely

150 Objects

"shared files"

References to non-existing shared files

15 Objects

Help files

References to missing help files of applications

16 Objects

Software

Information on the installations are wrong or faulty

18 Objects

History lists

Unnecessary information on recently used files

35 Objects

Description

Found 281 no longer needed registry entries, 281 of which are currently selected. Click "Delete now" to delete the selected entries.

Settings

Backups

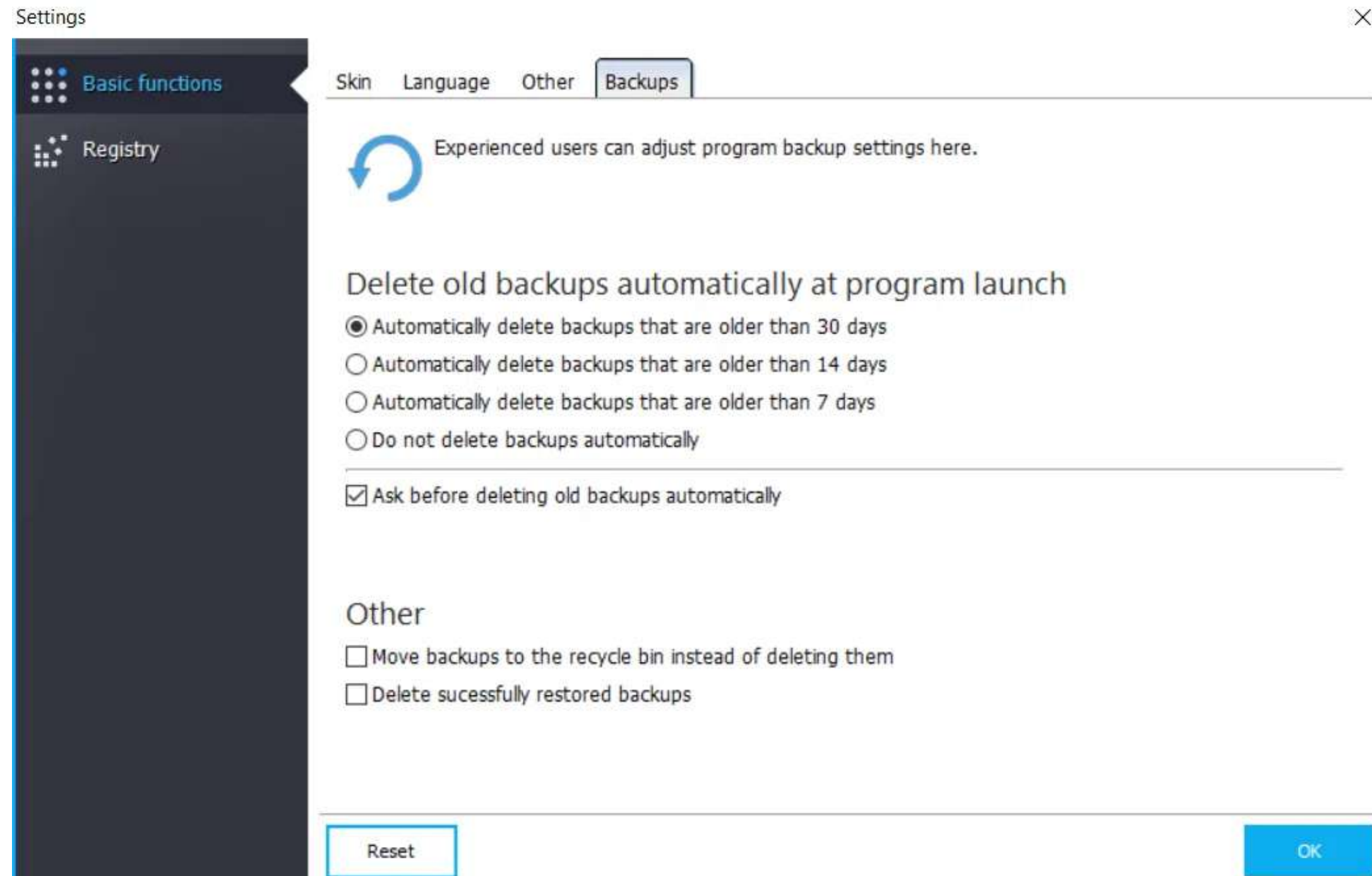
Create report

Abort

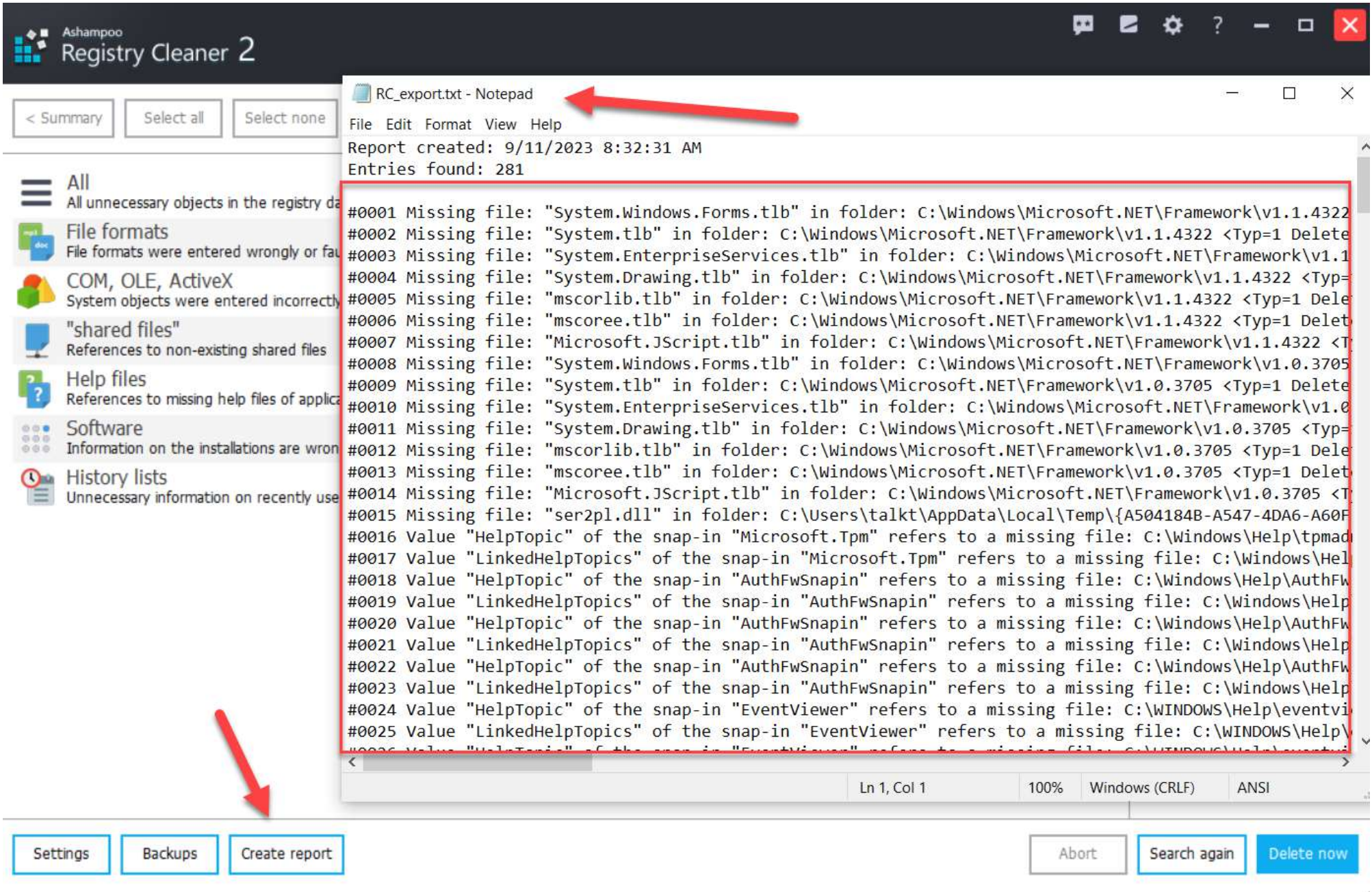
Search again

Delete now

The user interface includes multiple settings, including the ability to automatically delete old backups to reclaim space and reduce clutter.



By clicking a button, you can create a report listing all identified issues and items for review in a text editor like Notepad, as shown here.



Pros

- No restricted functionality in the free version
- Creates a backup automatically before addressing issues
- Offers a simple reporting feature to see review items
- Updates automatically

Cons

- Users must create an online account using a working email address.
- The tool doesn't include a way to undo changes made to registry.

As you may have recognized by now, there is no “best” free registry cleaner. Some of them are dedicated cleaners, while others offer other system optimization features. Some free versions have limited functionality, while others offer full cleaning capabilities. While a home user may not need a portable version, a part-time PC admin for a small not-for-profit organization may.

While tidying up your registry can sometimes be helpful, keep in mind that even one incorrect change to the registry can lead your operating system to the blue screen of death. Therefore, before you make any changes to your registry, be 100% sure of what you are changing, have current backups of your system and data, and track all the changes you make.

In fact, routinely tracking changes to your registry is a smart strategy. For example, one of the first steps malware often takes is to change registry startup keys. If you spot those changes quickly, you can take steps to block the malicious software before it does real damage to your systems and data.

Unfortunately, none of the cleaners described in this article are able to compare registry snapshots and notify users about findings or report them to a central system for

further processing. Another important caveat for use of registry cleaners, especially in a company environment, is that cleaning the registry might have a detrimental effect on existing audit and forensics processes, jeopardizing the company’s ability to document compliance and investigate security incidents. You can learn more about tracking Windows Server registry changes in this guide about detecting modifications to startup items in the Windows registry.

FREE EBOOK

Windows Registry Tutorial

Free Download

A Brief Guide to Help You Choose the Best SharePoint Reporting Tool



Ian Andersen
Vice President Pre Sales Engineering

Microsoft SharePoint is widely used by organizations to enhance collaboration, manage documents and streamline access to information. Users can easily store and organize documents, and collaborate effectively through shared workspaces, document libraries and lists. They can even open and edit Microsoft Office documents directly from SharePoint. SharePoint Online is part of Microsoft 365.

However, ensuring strong productivity, security and compliance requires effective management of the

SharePoint environment. Administrators need a robust SharePoint reporting tool that provides usage information, empowers them to understand who has access to what content, and reveals who is reading, modifying and deleting documents.

This document explores the key functionality to look for in a SharePoint reporting tool and then reviews some of the Microsoft and third-party solutions to consider.

What to Look for in a SharePoint Reporting Tool

Choosing a solid SharePoint reporting software can help you enhance the management, usability and security of your SharePoint environment. To choose the right tool for your organization, be sure to ask the following questions:

Which benefits are most important to us?

Document your goals for the SharePoint reporting tool. Here are some common benefits to consider:

- Get detailed reports for auditing and compliance purposes
- Inform optimization efforts with insights into resource allocation and usage over time
- Plan for future content strategies and site structures by analyzing activity trends
- Proactively identify vulnerabilities that put SharePoint security at risk
- Spot threats by promptly identifying suspicious activity around SharePoint content

What kinds of reports are available?

Make sure the tool offers the reports you require. Common reporting needs include:

- Usage reports that show how individuals or groups are using SharePoint
- Activity reports that track user actions such as uploads, edits, and check-in/checkout events
- Audit reports that show who has access to what and track all changes to permissions
- Health reports that monitor the state of the SharePoint environment
- Custom reports tailored to specific data points or business intelligence needs

Can I automate reporting?

Many SharePoint reporting tools offer automation features that allow you to have reports generated automatically on the schedule you specify and sent to specified email recipients. Some tools empower you to configure triggers that will generate reports based on specific events or thresholds.

Can I track SharePoint usage?

If your organization needs detailed insight into how SharePoint is being utilized, look for a tool that makes it easy to monitor when and how users log in and interact with documents, and even reveal usage patterns and peak periods.

Can I track activity in SharePoint?

Make sure the SharePoint reporting tool you select empowers you to monitor the user activity you care about. Examples include file access, edits, uploads and deletions; site usage; changes to access permissions; security-related events; and workflow progress.

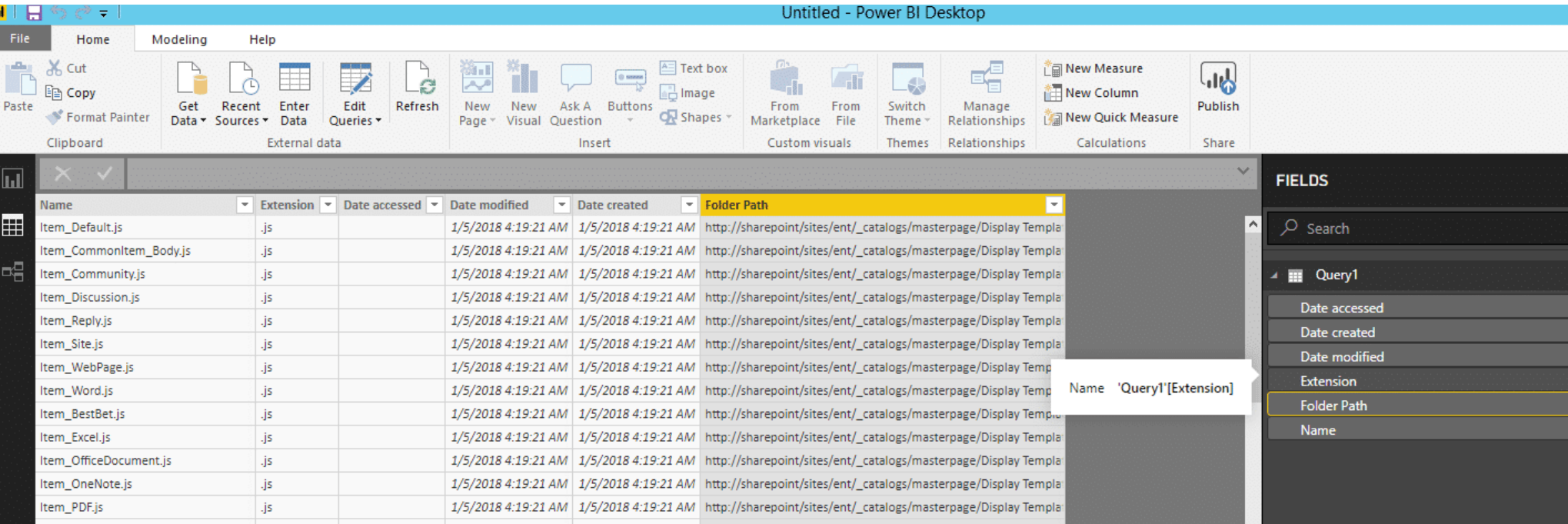
Leading SharePoint Reporting Solutions Available Today

Microsoft Power BI

Microsoft Power BI, while not strictly a SharePoint reporting tool, offers robust data visualization capabilities that can transform SharePoint data into engaging interactive reports and dashboards for business users, IT professionals and developers, facilitating in-depth data analysis and reporting. Moreover, its built-in connectors enable you to swiftly integrate diverse data sources, such as SQL Server logs, for comprehensive reports that include information from across the organization.

While there is Pro version that enables users to present more data, the free version of Power BI will meet most basic reporting needs. Installation is straightforward but does require a Microsoft account.

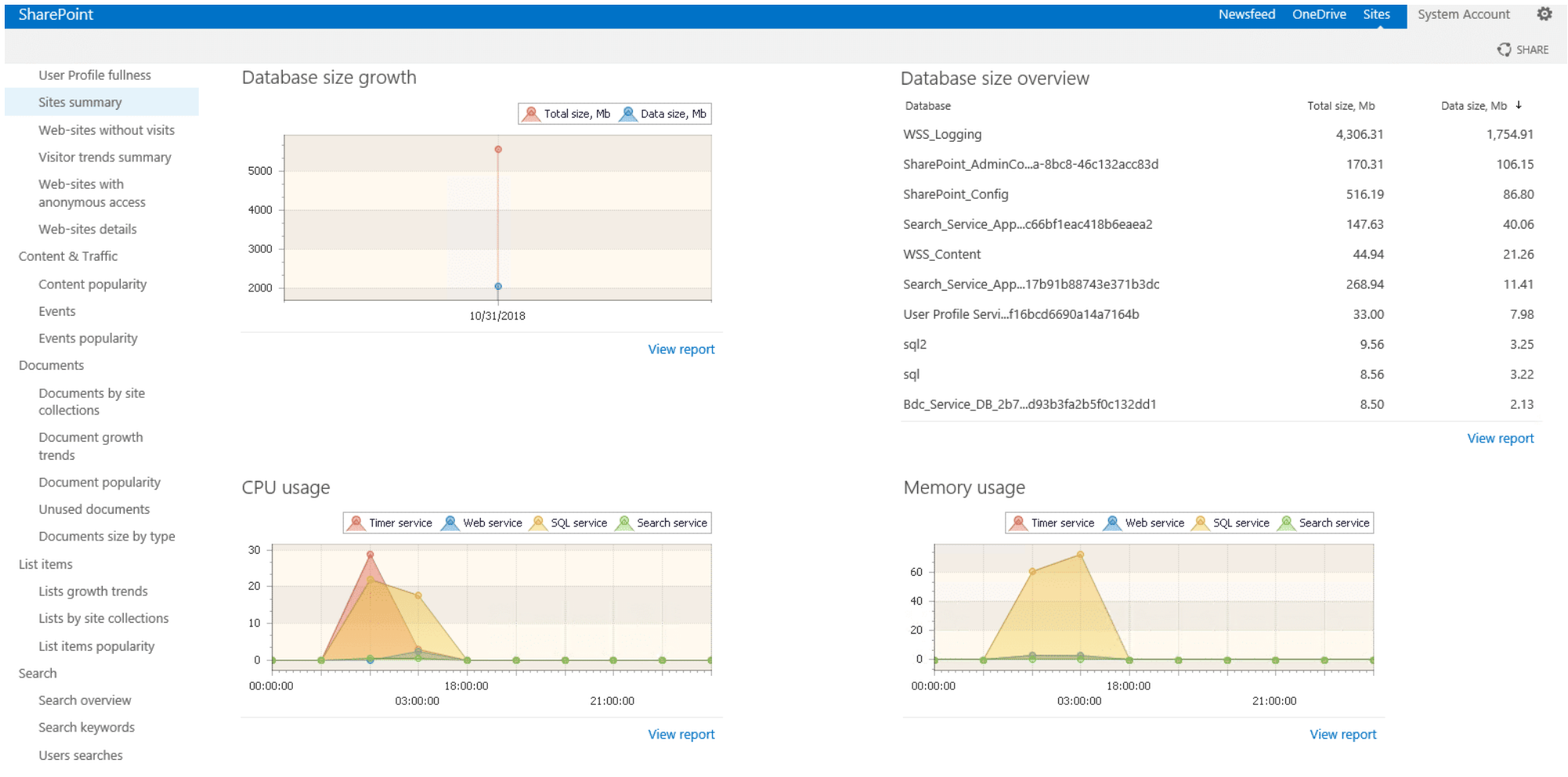
The interface is user-friendly but, unlike some other tools, Power BI doesn't offer pre-made reports. You must use a tool like PowerShell to export data to CSV files and then import those files into Power BI. Despite this inconvenience, it's an effective tool for visualizing log data.



HarePoint Analytics for Microsoft

HarePoint Analytics for Microsoft SharePoint provides detailed analytics and usage reports for SharePoint sites to help organizations understand how their SharePoint environment is used so they can and optimize it. The tool offers comprehensive reports on site and list usage and content details; for example, you can quickly analyze document popularity and size distribution. To help you identify improper activity, HarePoint Analytics provides reports on document interactions and site visits, even tracking the originating computer.

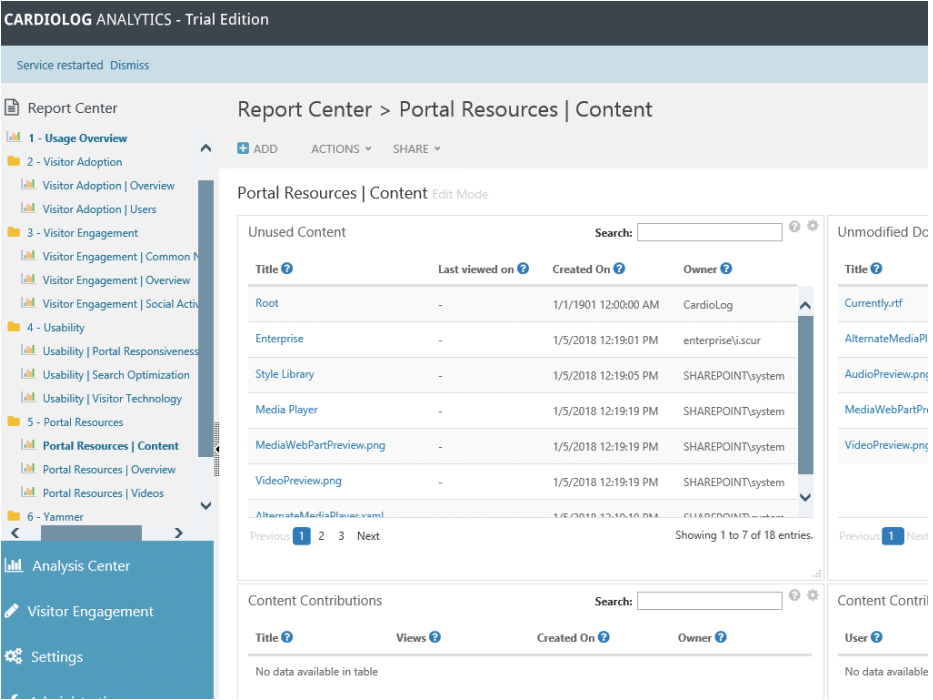
The tool is quick to install and configure. It integrates into your SharePoint configuration settings and is available only from the SharePoint Administration Center.



CardioLog AnalyticsSharePoint

CardioLog Analytics is a comprehensive SharePoint analytics tool with in-depth reporting capabilities. It provides a suite of business statistics for understanding and optimizing site navigation, design and content, including analysis of the most popular items, user engagement, search efficacy, content usage and changes. Data export options include PDF and CSV. Additionally, its Voice of Customer feature facilitates user engagement through surveys.

Installation requires the latest .NET Framework and specific Microsoft updates, which may extend setup time due to required restarts. A 30-day free trial will enable you to explore the software's full potential.



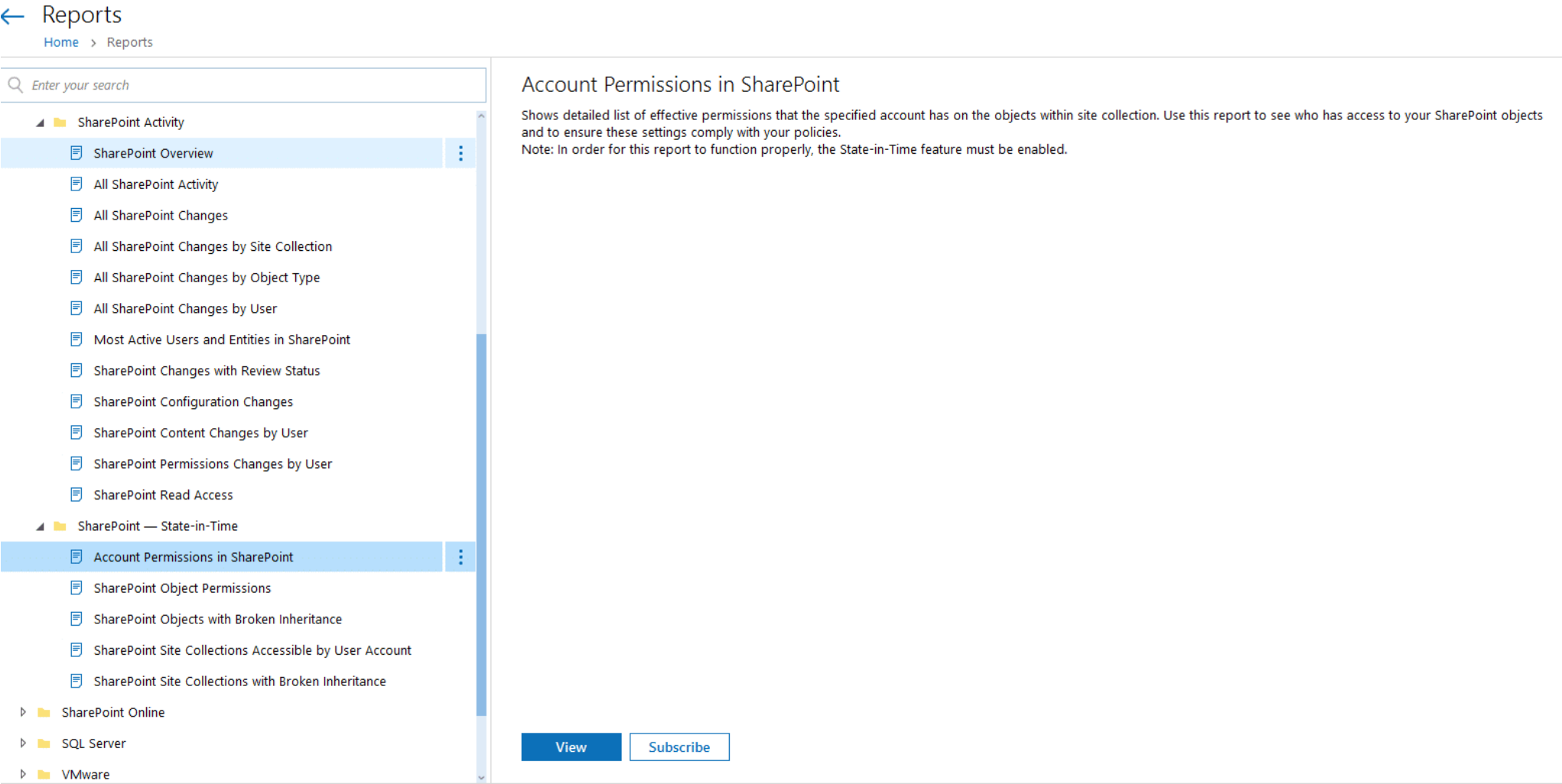
Netwrix Auditor for SharePoint

[Netwrix Auditor for SharePoint](#) efficiently tracks and reports on changes within SharePoint, including farm configuration, user content, permissions, group membership and security policies. It provides comprehensive details for auditing, such as who made each change, when and where it happened, and the crucial before and after values. IT administrators can rapidly investigate changes using the Interactive Search feature and set up alerts for email notifications on specific triggers.

The software also offers state-in-time reports on object permissions, group membership and other key aspects of SharePoint. These reports, facilitated by SQL Server Reporting Services, can be automatically delivered via email to streamline regular monitoring. Netwrix Auditor for SharePoint addresses the issue of audit log trimming by storing logs for over ten years.

The installation and configuration processes are quick and straightforward, and a 20-day free trial allows you to explore its full range of features.

There is also a free version of this product, Netwrix Auditor for SharePoint Free Community Edition. Though its capabilities are limited, you can get a daily report on all changes to your SharePoint farm during the past 24 hours, including the details about when and where each change was made.



EVMicrosoft PowerShell

Microsoft PowerShell is a powerful scripting language and command-line shell that can be used as a SharePoint reporting tool. You can create detailed reports on site collections, user permissions, content usage, security settings, and more, tailoring the reports to your specific needs. You can also automate report generation. You can run PowerShell using either the SharePoint Management Shell or the convenient PowerShell ISE.

In addition to reporting, you can use PowerShell to manipulate and modify SharePoint objects, which makes it a powerful tool for efficiently managing even large and complex SharePoint deployments.

Before you can execute SharePoint commands in the PowerShell ISE, you need to load the Windows PowerShell snap-in for SharePoint by running the following command:

```
Add-PSSnapin Microsoft.SharePoint.PowerShell
```

Then you can use SharePoint reporting scripts. Here are several scripts that you might find handy:

List all site collections in a farm

```
Get-SPSite -Limit All |  
  
Select -ExpandProperty AllWebs |
```

```
Select -ExpandProperty Lists |  
  
Select {$_.ParentWeb.Url}, Title
```

Report on a certain file on a SharePoint site

```
Get-SPWeb http://sharepoint/sites/enterprise |  
  
Select -ExpandProperty Lists |  
  
Where { $_.GetType().Name -eq "SPDocumentLibrary" -and  
  
-not $_.Hidden } |  
  
Select -ExpandProperty Items |  
  
Where { $_.Name -like "*FileName*" } |  
  
Select Name, {$_.File.Length}, url
```

Report on all files created by a certain Active Directory user

```
Get-SPWeb http://sharepoint/sites/enterprise |  
  
Select -ExpandProperty Lists |  
  
Where { $_.GetType().Name -eq "SPDocumentLibrary" -and  
  
-not $_.Hidden } |  
  
Select -ExpandProperty Items |  
  
Where { $_["Created By"] -like "*UserName*" } |  
  
Select Name, url, {$_["Created By"]}
```

Report on all files with a specified extension

```
Get-SPWeb http://sharepoint/sites/enterprise |

Select -ExpandProperty Lists |

    Where { $_.GetType().Name -eq "SPDocumentLibrary" -and

        -not $_.Hidden } |

    Select -ExpandProperty Items |

    Where { $_.Name -Like "*.rtf" } |

    Select Name,

        @{Name="URL";

            Expression={$_.ParentList.ParentWeb.Url + "/" + $_.Url}}

format-table -AutoSize
```

Report on the number of files that are hosted your sites and their total size

```
Get-SPWeb http://sharepoint/sites/enterprise |

    Select -ExpandProperty Lists |

        Where { $_.GetType().Name -eq "SPDocumentLibrary" -and

            -not $_.Hidden } |

        Select -ExpandProperty Items |

            Group {$_.ParentList.ParentWeb.Url +

                "/" + $_.ParentList.Title} |

                Select Name, count,

                    @{Name='Total';

                        Expression={$_.Group |

                            ForEach-Object {

                                -Begin {$total=0;}

                                -Process {$total+=[int]$_.

                                    File.Length}

                                -End {$total}

                            }

                        } |

                    format-table -AutoSize
```

Deciding on the best SharePoint reporting tool depends on your needs and expertise. PowerShell can seem like a great option, since it's free, flexible and powerful. However, keep in mind that mastering the cmdlets and creating and maintaining scripts can require significant time and expertise. If you prefer a more user-friendly option, a third-party SharePoint reporting tool can be a better choice; look for one that is quick to set up and provides immediate access to a range of ready-to-use reports and analytics.

Ultimately, the right tool for you should align with your specific reporting goals and the level of detail you need. Assess your requirements thoroughly to choose a solution that meets your SharePoint reporting objectives.

FREE EBOOK

The Ultimate Guide to SharePoint Permissions Best Practices

Free Download

How-to for IT Pro

HOW TO GET A LIST OF ALL USERS FROM A SPECIFIC OU

- 1. Open the Powershell ISE -> Run the following script, adjusting the OU and export paths:

```
$OUpath = 'ou=Managers,dc=enterprise,dc=com'
$ExportPath = 'c:\data\users_in_ou1.csv'
Get-ADUser -Filter * -SearchBase $OUpath |
Select-object
DistinguishedName,Name,UserPrincipalName
| Export-Csv -NoType $ExportPath
```

- 2. Open the file produced by the script in MS Excel.

	A	B	C
1	DistinguishedName	Name	UserPrincipalName
2	CN=Elena Swift,OU=Managers,DC=enterprise,DC=com	Elena Swift	E.Swift@enterprise.com
3	CN=Max Ludwig,OU=Managers,DC=enterprise,DC=com	Max Ludwig	M.Ludwig@enterprise.com
4	CN=Jane Holden,OU=Managers,DC=enterprise,DC=com	Jane Holden	J.Holden@enterprise.com
5	CN=Anna Kowalski,OU=Managers,DC=enterprise,DC=com	Anna Kowalski	A.Kowalski@enterprise.com
6			
7			

TOOL OF THE MONTH

Netwrix Auditor
for Windows
Server

Request One-to-One Demo

Netwrix Auditor for Windows Server enhances security and compliance by offering complete visibility into what’s happening in your Windows-based server infrastructure including configurations, file changes, and access events. It helps in the early detection of suspicious activities, ensuring a swift response to potential threats. With its detailed analytics, it aids in identifying security vulnerabilities and enforcing least privilege principles, making Windows Server environments more secure and well-managed.

Regularly review your server configuration and spot deviations from a known good baseline

Windows Server Configuration Details

Provides review of Windows server configuration. For a server, the following details are reported: its OS, antivirus, local users and groups, file shares, installed programs, and services. You can apply baseline filters to highlight security issues, such as outdated operating system or improper antivirus. Use this report to examine server configuration details and proactively mitigate risks in your environment.

Category: General

Server	OS Name	OS Version	Antivirus Status
DC02.sbarchcloud.com	Microsoft Windows Server 2012 R2 Standard	6.3.9600	Issues Detected

Category: Update configuration

Setting name	Setting value	Configuration source	Winning policy
Auto Update	Disabled	Set Locally	Not available
Windows Server Update Services	Not configured	Not available	Not available

Category: File Shares

Object type	Object name	Object path	Properties
Default Share	ADMIN\$	C:\Windows	Description: Remote Admin
Default Share	C\$	C:\	Description: Default share
Default Share	D\$	D:\	Description: Default share
Shared Folder	NETLOGON	C:\Windows\SYSVOL\sysvol\sbarchcloud.com\SCRIPTS	Description: Logon server share

Detect critical security events with continuous Windows Server monitoring and alerting

Netwrix Auditor Alert

Possible ransomware activity

Who:	ENTERPRISE\J.Carter
Action:	Modified
Object type:	Registry Key
	HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Wow6432Node\Microsoft\Windows\
When:	CurrentVersion\Run
Where:	5/2/2017 6:41:14 PM
Data source:	srv027.enterprise.com
Monitoring plan:	Windows Server
Details:	Enterprise Visibility Plan
	Added Umbercrypt (REG_SZ): C:\Windows\Umbercrypt.exe

This message was sent by Netwrix Auditor from au-srv-fin.enterprise.com.

Investigate suspicious changes made to your server objects and settings

← Search	Who	Action	What	When	Where
Data source	"Windows Server" x	Object Type not	"Registry Key" x		
			SEARCH		
Who	Object type	Action	What	When	Where
Not applicable Status: OK	Pointing Device	Added	System Information\ Components\ Input\Pointing Device\TER...	SbSilver002-AP2	3/25/2024 1:40:24 PM
Not applicable Status: OK	Keyboard	Added	SystemInformation\Components\ Input\Keyboard\TERMINPU...	SbSilver002-AP2	3/25/2024 1:40:24 PM
SARCHCLOUD\SBSILVER002-AP2\$ Name: WpnUserService_31137e2	System Service	Added	Windows Push Notifications User Service_31137e2	SbSilver002-AP2	3/25/2024 1:31:57 PM
SARCHCLOUD\SBSILVER002-AP2\$ Name: UserDataSvc_31137e2	System Service	Added	User Data Access_31137e2	SbSilver002-AP2	3/25/2024 1:31:57 PM
SARCHCLOUD\SBSILVER002-AP2\$ Name: UnistoreSvc_31137e2	System Service	Added	User Data Storage_31137e2	SbSilver002-AP2	3/25/2024 1:31:57 PM



[On-Demand Webinar]

Automate & Elevate: Best Practices in Group and Identity Security



Jonathan Blackwell
Director of Engineering

Properly managing identities and groups is vital for avoiding costly data breaches, business downtime and compliance findings.

Watch this webinar to learn about best practices for group and identity management using Netwrix GroupID. You will get practical strategies for scaling your practices as your organization grows and adapting to other changes in your environment, empowering you to strengthen security while reducing your IT workload.

Using real-world case studies, we'll explore multiple ways you can strengthen security while improving efficiency, including:

- Automating the identification and handling of stale groups
- Provisioning identities automatically from your HR system to your directory
- Keeping the membership of critical roles and groups updated automatically
- Improving identity and group governance with lifecycle management
- Gaining the visibility critical for stronger decision-making

[Watch Now](#)



What did you think
of this issue?



About Netwrix

Netwrix champions cybersecurity to ensure a brighter digital future for any organization. Netwrix's innovative solutions safeguard data, identities, and infrastructure reducing both the risk and impact of a breach for more than 13,500 organizations across 100+ countries. Netwrix empowers security professionals to face digital threats with confidence by enabling them to identify and protect sensitive data as well as to detect, respond to, and recover from attacks.

For more information visit www.netwrix.com

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